MUST-SCORE FACTS

Medieval India

Consolidated Must-Score Facts and must-score drill cards for every chapter.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

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Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts

1. Delhi Sultanate Chronology & Dynastic Founders

Dynasty	Period	Founder	Greatest / Key Ruler	Last Ruler	Capital
Slave / Mamluk / Ilbari	**1206–1290**	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (Lakhbaksh)	**Iltutmish** (real consolidator, introduced Silver Tanka & Copper Jital, Chalisa / Turkan-i-Chahalgani), **Balban** (Blood and Iron policy, Sijda & Paibos, Nauroz festival)	Kayumars (killed by Jalaluddin)	Lahore → Delhi (Iltutmish made Delhi capital)
Khalji	**1290–1320**	**Jalaluddin Khalji**	**Alauddin Khalji** (Market regulations / Shahna-i-Mandi, Dagh & Chehra, expanded to South India under Malik Kafur)	Khusrau Khan (usurper)	Delhi (Siri Fort)
Tughlaq (*Longest ruling: 94 yrs*)	**1320–1414**	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (Ghazi Malik; built Tughlaqabad)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Token currency, capital shift to Daulatabad, Qarachil & Khurasan expeditions), **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (Canals, cities: Jaunpur, Firozabad, Hissar)	Nasiruddin Mahmud (Timur invaded in **1398 CE** during his reign)	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	**1414–1451**	**Khizr Khan** (governor of Multan under Timur; took title *Raiyat-i-Ala*, never called himself Sultan)	Mubarak Shah (patron of Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi - *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*)	Alam Shah (abdicated voluntarily)	Delhi
Lodi (*First Afghan Dynasty*)	**1451–1526**	**Bahlul Lodi** (issued Bahloli coins)	**Sikandar Lodi** (Founded **Agra in 1504**, capital in 1506; wrote poetry as *Gulrukhi*; introduced **Gaz-i-Sikandari** 39 digits)	**Ibrahim Lodi** (Defeated & killed at First Battle of Panipat, 1526)	Delhi → Agra

> **Logic:** Sultanate spine is **Slave 1206–1290 → Khalji 1290–1320 → Tughlaq 1320–1414 → Sayyid 1414–1451 → Lodi 1451–1526**. Do not stop at the founder year.

1A. Ghaznavid & Ghurid (before Delhi)

House	Period (from–to)	Key raids / rulers	Last / end
Ghaznavid (Mahmud of Ghazni)	Raids **1000–1027 CE** (17 expeditions in Indian tradition)	**Somnath 1025**; Al-Biruni came with him; capital Ghazni	Line continues in Afghanistan; **not** the Delhi Sultanate
Ghurid (Muhammad Ghori)	Indian career **1173–1206**	**Tarain I 1191** lost to Prithviraj; **Tarain II 1192** won; **Chandawar 1194** vs Jaichand	Murdered **1206**; slave generals (Aibak, Yalduz, Qubacha, Bakhtiyar) take the north

1B. Mughal Emperors — From / To, Last, High-Yield

Imperial high point **1526–1707**; the house on paper lasts to **1857**.

Emperor	Period (from–to)	Last / how it ended	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Babur	**1526–1530**	Died; buried **Kabul** (not Delhi)	Agra	Panipat I (**21 Apr 1526**, *Tulughma* + *Araba*); Khanwa 1527 (title *Ghazi*); Chanderi 1528; Ghaghra 1529. *Baburnama* in **Chagatai Turkish**.
Humayun	**1530–1540** and **1555–1556**	First reign ends at **Kannauj/Bilgram 1540**; restored **Sirhind 1555**; died 1556 (Sher Mandal stairs). Tomb **Delhi**	Agra / Delhi	Lost **Chausa 1539** and Kannauj 1540 to Sher Shah. Do not swap Daurah **1532** with Dharmat **1658**.
Sur (Afghan interregnum)	**1540–1555**	**Sikandar Shah Suri** beaten at Sirhind 1555	Delhi / Sasaram	**Sher Shah 1540–1545**: GT Road, rupiya, sarkar–pargana, Sasaram tomb. Islam Shah follows. **Not** a Mughal house.
Akbar	**1556–1605**	Died; buried **Sikandra (Agra)**	Agra → **Fatehpur Sikri (1571–85)** → Lahore / Agra	Panipat II **5 Nov 1556** (Bairam Khan vs Hemu). *Zabt / Dahsala 1580–81* (Todar Mal). Abolished jizya **1564**. Ibadat Khana 1575; *Sulh-i-Kul*; Din-i-Ilahi **1582**. Allahabad fort **1583**. *Ain-i-Akbari* (Abul Fazl).

Emperor	Period (from–to)	Last / how it ended	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Jahangir	**1605–1627**	Died; buried **Lahore** (Shahdara)	Agra / Lahore	*Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*. Hawkins **1608** (*English Khan*); **Sir Thomas Roe 1615–19**. Nur Jahan's party. Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah (Nur Jahan).
Shah Jahan	**1628–1658** (died 1666 in Agra Fort)	Deposed by Aurangzeb after Samugarh; buried **Taj / Agra**	Agra → **Shahjahanabad (Delhi)**	Taj Mahal **1631–48** (Ustad Ahmad Lahori). Red Fort & Jama Masjid. Peacock Throne. Patron of Kavindra Acharya (Banaras).
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	**1658–1707**	Died **Ahmadnagar 1707**; buried Khuldabad	Delhi / Deccan camps	Dharmat Apr 1658 → Samugarh May 1658 → Deorai 1659. Reimposed jizya **1679**. Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**. About **21 subahs**. Shivaji coronation **1674** in his reign.
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam)	**1707–1712**	Died; **not** the 1857 emperor	Delhi	Won **Jajau 1707** vs Azam. Khafi Khan: *Shahe Bekhabar*.
Bahadur Shah II Zafar	**1837–1857**	Last Mughal; **1857** Delhi; exiled **Rangoon**	Red Fort, Delhi	Son of **Akbar II**. Teachers Zauq & Ghalib. Do **not** merge with Bahadur Shah I.

> **Logic:** Mughal **founded 1526**, imperial end **1707** (Aurangzeb), legal end **1857** (Zafar). Humayun's gap **1540–1555** is **Sur**, not "Mughal continued."

1C. Regional houses — From / To (often asked as founder-only)

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler / end	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Vijayanagara	**1336–1565** as great power; Aravidu remnant to **c. 1646**	**Harihara I & Bukka I** (Sangama; Vidyaranya tradition)	**Rama Raya** killed at **Talikota 23 Jan 1565**; later Aravidu at Penukonda / Chandragiri	**Hampi** (Tungabhadra)	Order: **Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu**. Peak **Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva)** — *Amuktamalyada* (Telugu); Paes & Barbosa visited. *Nayankara / amara*. Mahanavami Dibba. Berar **absent** from the Talikota alliance.
Bahmani	**1347–1518/1527**	**Hasan Gangu = Alauddin Bahman Shah**	Splits **1518** into five Deccan Sultanates	**Gulbarga → Bidar**	**Mahmud Gawan** (prime minister; executed **1481**). Nikitin visited. Tin Darwaza = **Bidar**, not Ahmedabad.
Five Deccan Sultanates	From **c. 1518**	—	Absorbed by Mughals (Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**)	Bijapur, Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, Berar	Adil Shahi, Qutb Shahi, Nizam Shahi, Barid Shahi, Imad Shahi. Charminar = Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.
Sharqi (Jaunpur, UP)	**c. 1394–1479/1484**	**Malik Sarwar** (*Malik-us-Sharq / Khwaja-i-Jahan*)	**Hussain Shah** falls to **Bahlul Lodi**	**Jaunpur** (eastern UP)	City founded by **Firuz Tughlaq** for cousin Jauna Khan — city ≠ dynasty. **Ibrahim Shah** — *Siraj-i-Hind*; **Atala Masjid**. Vidyapati's *Kirtilata*; Jaisi's *Padmavat* in this circle. **Only this regional capital sits in modern UP.**
Maratha Swaraj / Confederacy	**1674–1818**	**Shivaji** crowned **Raigad 1674** (Gaga Bhatt)	**Peshwa Bajirao II**; Third Anglo-Maratha War **1817–18** ends Peshwaship	Raigad → later Poona (Peshwas)	Chauth 25% + Sardeshmukhi 10%. Purandar **1665** (Jai Singh I). Panipat III **1761**.

1D. Uttarakhand medieval houses (UKPCS)

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler / end	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Katyuri / Kattyuri	**c. 740–1050 CE**	**Basantandev (Basu Dev)**	Tyrant **Bir Dev / Biram Dev** overthrown; realm splits (Askot, Doti, Dwarahat, Baijnath)	**Joshimath (Kartikeyapura) → Baijnath** (Katyur valley, Bageshwar)	First historic empire of the hills. Unifier **Ishtaganadeva**. Apex **Lalitsuradeva** (Pandukeshwar plates). Bageshwar inscription of **Bhuwandev**.
Chand of Kumaon	c. 10th/11th c. legend → **1790**	**Somchand** (Jhusi/Prayag tradition) at **Champawat (Rajbunga)**	**Mahendra Chand** defeated by Gorkhas at **Hawalbagh, Jan 1790**	Champawat → **Almora (1563)** under Balo Kalyan Chand	Emblem **Garud**. **Char Aal**: Karki, Bora, Taragi, Chaudhary. Garud Gyan Chand vs Firoz Tughlaq. Baz Bahadur Chand — Taklakot / Kailash route. Tax memory: **36 Rakam 32 Kalam**.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler / end	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Parmar / Panwar of Garhwal	Legend **Kanakpal 888 CE → 1804**	**Kanakpal** at **Chandpur Garhi** (Chamoli)	**Pradyumna Shah** dies vs Gorkhas at **Khudbuda / Khurbura (Dehradun), 14 May 1804**	Chandpur → Dewalgarh (1512) → **Srinagar (1517)**	**Ajay Pal** unites **52 garhs**. Rani **Karnavati** (*Nakkati Rani*, 1635). Fateh Shah grants four villages to **Guru Ram Rai** (1676). Painter **Mola Ram**.

2. Central Administrative Departments (Diwan-i-...)

Department Name	Portfolio / Nature of Office	Creator / Reformer Sultan	Key Official in Charge
Diwan-i-Wizarat	**Finance & Revenue Department** (Prime Minister)	Existed throughout; reorganized by Balban	**Wazir**
Diwan-i-Arz	**Military Department** (recruitment, inspection, muster rolls)	Created by **Ghiyasuddin Balban**	**Ariz-i-Mamalik** (Sultan remained supreme commander)
Diwan-i-Insha	**Royal Correspondence & State Chancery**	Early Sultanate	**Dabir-i-Khas**
Diwan-i-Risalat	**Religious Matters, Charities, Endowments & Foreign Appeals**	Early Sultanate	**Sadr-us-Sudur**
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Department for **Extracting Arrears from Revenue Officers**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	Mustakhraj officers
Diwan-i-Riyasat	**Market Control & Commerce Regulatory Department**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	**Naib-i-Riyasat** (controlled Shahna-i-Mandi)
Diwan-i-Kohi	**Agriculture Development Department** (crop loans/Sondhar, experimental farms)	Created by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	Amir-i-Kohi
Diwan-i-Khairat	**Charity & Public Welfare** (aid for poor, widows, orphan marriages)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Royal almoners
Diwan-i-Bandagan	**Department of Royal Slaves** (~1,80,000 slaves trained in crafts)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Khwajasara
Diwan-i-Ishtiaq	**Pension Department** for retired and destitute officials	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	-
Diwan-i-Qaza	**Judicial Department** (Civil & Criminal justice)	Established early	**Qazi-ul-Quzat**
Barid-i-Mamalik	**Intelligence & Royal Postal Spies**	Reorganized by Balban & Alauddin	Barids (reporters)
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights/Measures**	Alauddin / Firoz / Aurangzeb	Muhtasib
Dar-ul-Shafa	**Free Royal Charitable Hospital**	Built by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Hakims

2B. Delhi Sultanate Territorial & Local Administrative Hierarchy

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Iqta / Wilayat (Province) ⟶ Shiq (District) ⟶ Pargana (Sub-district) ⟶ Deh / Gram (Village)
[Head: Muqti / Wali]          [Head: Shiqdar]     [Head: Amil / Mushrif]     [Head: Muqaddam / Khut]
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Administrative Unit	Heading Officer / Functionary	Nature of Authority / Duties
Iqta / Wilayat (Province)	**Muqti / Wali / Naib Sultan**	Maintained law & order, commanded provincial troops, collected revenue, remitted surplus (*Fawazil*) to Centre
Shiq (District)	**Shiqdar**	Head of executive and military administration of the district
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Amil / Mushrif**	Assessed and collected agricultural revenue from villages
Pargana Accounts	**Karkun / Nawisinda**	Scribe and accountant maintaining land registers in Persian and Hindi
Pargana Treasury	**Fotadar / Khazandar**	Custodian of the local treasury and cash receipts
Deh / Gram (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Village headman; collected land revenue from peasants
Village Landed Elite	**Khut**	Rich peasant / hereditary village landlord (Alauddin stripped their privileges)

Administrative Unit	Heading Officer / Functionary	Nature of Authority / Duties
Village Official	**Patwari**	Maintained village land survey and revenue assessment registers
Village Group Leader	**Chaudhari**	100-village leader acting as intermediary between state and villages

3. Medieval Indian Architecture & Monuments Chronology

Monument / Structure	Location	Builder / Sultan / Emperor	Architectural Landmark / Exam Highlight
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1193 CE)	**First mosque built in Delhi**; constructed using materials from 27 demolished temples
Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra	Ajmer (Rajasthan)	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1199 CE)	Built on the ruins of a Sanskrit college (*Saraswati Kanthabharana* built by Vigraharaja IV)
Qutb Minar	Mehrauli, Delhi	Started by Aibak; **completed by Iltutmish**; repaired by Firoz Tughlaq	Dedicated to Sufi saint Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki; 72.5 m red sandstone
Tomb of Balban	Mehrauli, Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Balban** (c. 1287)	**First true architectural arch (*True Arch*)** constructed in India
Alai Darwaza	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji** (1311 CE)	**First true horseshoe arch and true dome in India**; exquisite red sandstone & white marble
Siri Fort & Hauz Khas	Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji**	Siri Fort built to protect Delhi against Mongol raids
Tughlaqabad Fort	Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**	Sloping battered walls (*batter*) and stone masonry
Kotla Firoz Shah	Delhi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Ashokan pillar brought from Topra (Haryana) and installed atop 3-tiered pyramid
Atala Masjid	**Jaunpur (Uttar Pradesh)**	**Ibrahim Shah Sharqi** (1408 CE)	Sharqi style; sloping pylons, massive central propylon gate, no minarets
Tomb of Sikandar Lodi	Lodi Gardens, Delhi	Ibrahim Lodi (1517 CE)	**First double dome in India**; octagonal plan set within a walled garden
Sasaram Tomb	Sasaram (Bihar)	**Sher Shah Suri** (architect Aliwal Khan)	Octagonal red sandstone tomb situated in the middle of an artificial square lake
Purana Qila & Qila-i-Kuhna	Delhi	**Sher Shah Suri**	Qila-i-Kuhna mosque represents transition to refined Mughal architectural aesthetic
Humayun's Tomb	Delhi	Begum Bega / Haji Begum (architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas, 1565)	**First grand garden-tomb in India (*Charbagh*)**; precursor and model for the Taj Mahal; white marble double dome; UNESCO WHS
Agra Fort	Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1565–1573)	Massive red sandstone ramparts on the Yamuna; Jahangiri Mahal
Fatehpur Sikri Complex	Near Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1571–1585)	City of victory: **Buland Darwaza** (1601, commemorating conquest of Gujarat; 54 m high), **Panch Mahal** (5-tier Buddhist-inspired pyramid), **Ibadat Khana** (1575), Tomb of Sheikh Salim Chishti (white marble lattice *Jali*)
Akbar's Tomb	Sikandra, Agra (UP)	Begun by Akbar; **completed by Jahangir** (1613)	Unique tier without a central dome; minarets at four corners
Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah	Agra (UP)	**Empress Nur Jahan** (1628)	Tomb of her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg; **first building made entirely of white marble** with extensive **Pietra Dura** (floral inlay with semi-precious stones); called **"Baby Taj"**
Taj Mahal	Agra (UP)	**Shah Jahan** (1631–1648)	Masterpiece of Indo-Islamic architecture; chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**; calligrapher Amanat Khan; UNESCO WHS
Red Fort & Jama Masjid	Delhi	**Shah Jahan** (1638–1648)	Shifted capital from Agra to **Shahjahanabad**; Diwan-i-Aam, Diwan-i-Khas (*"If there is a paradise on earth, it is this…"*), Peacock Throne (*Takht-i-Taus*)
Bibi Ka Maqbara	Aurangabad (Maharashtra)	**Aurangzeb / Prince Azam Shah** (1678)	Tomb of Dilras Banu Begum (Rabia-ud-Daurani); known as **"Dakhani Taj"** or poor man's replica of Taj
Moti Masjid (Red Fort Delhi)	Delhi	**Aurangzeb** (1659)	White marble private mosque within the Red Fort

Monument / Structure	Location	Builder / Sultan / Emperor	Architectural Landmark / Exam Highlight
Badshahi Mosque	Lahore (Pakistan)	**Aurangzeb** (1673)	Largest mosque of the Mughal Empire

4. Medieval Literature & Chroniclers (The Complete Exam Sheet)

Book / Work Title	Author	Language / Patron Ruler	Key Subject / Historical Value
Kitab-ul-Hind* / *Tahqiq-i-Hind	**Al-Biruni**	Arabic / Mahmud of Ghazni	Encyclopedic study of Indian religion, science, astronomy, and society
Chachnama	Translated by Ali Kufi	Persian (original Arabic)	History of the Arab conquest of Sindh by Muhammad bin Qasim (712 CE)
Taj-ul-Maasir	**Hasan Nizami**	Persian / Qutbuddin Aibak	First official chronicle of the Delhi Sultanate
Tabakat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj**	Persian / Nasiruddin Mahmud	Detailed political history from Muhammad Ghori to the Slave Dynasty
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi & ***Fatwa-i-Jahandari***	**Ziauddin Barani**	Persian / Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Eyewitness account of Alauddin's market reforms and Muhammad bin Tughlaq's schemes
Futuhat-i-Firoz Shahi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography detailing his public works, charities, and orthodox reforms
Tughlaq Nama, Khazain-ul-Futuh, Qiran-us-Sadain, Nuh Sipihr, Ashiqa	**Amir Khusrau** (*Tuti-i-Hind*)	Persian / Sultanate (Balban to Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq)	*Khazain-ul-Futuh* records Alauddin's conquests; *Nuh Sipihr* praises India's climate, flora, and culture; invented **Sitar**, **Qawwali**, and **Khayal** singing
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	**Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**	Persian / Mubarak Shah Sayyid	Only contemporary source for the Sayyid Dynasty
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	**Babur**	**Chagatai Turkish**	Candid royal memoirs; mentions 5 Muslim rulers (Delhi, Gujarat, Bahmani, Malwa, Bengal) and 2 Hindu kings (Krishnadeva Raya & Rana Sanga); translated into Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan
Humayun-nama	**Gulbadan Begum** (Babur's daughter)	Persian / Akbar	Intimate royal domestic account of the lives of Babur and Humayun
Akbarnama* & *Ain-i-Akbari	**Abul Fazl**	Persian / Akbar	Official history in 3 volumes: Vol 1 (Ancestry), Vol 2 (Akbar's reign), Vol 3 (*Ain-i-Akbari* - administrative gazetteer, revenue statistics)
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	**Abdul Qadir Badauni**	Persian / Akbar	Critical counter-narrative of Akbar's religious policies; translated Ramayana and Mahabharata (*Razmnama*) into Persian
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	**Jahangir** (completed by Mutamid Khan)	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography; reveals his passion for painting, birds, flowers, and natural history
Padshahnama	**Abdul Hamid Lahori**	Persian / Shah Jahan	Official illustrated chronicle of the first two decades of Shah Jahan's reign
Shah Jahan-nama	**Inayat Khan**	Persian / Shah Jahan	History of Shah Jahan's reign
Sirr-i-Akbar* & *Majma-ul-Bahrain	**Dara Shikoh**	Persian	*Sirr-i-Akbar* is the Persian translation of **50 Upanishads**; *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*The Mingling of Two Oceans*) harmonized Sufi and Vedantic philosophy
Alamgirnama	**Mirza Muhammad Kazim**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Official history of the first 10 years of Aurangzeb's reign (stopped by Emperor)
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	**Khafi Khan**	Persian / Later Mughal	Secretly written history of Aurangzeb's reign and Deccan campaigns
Nuskha-i-Dilkusha	**Bhimsen Saxena**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Eyewitness account of Aurangzeb's Deccan wars written from a non-courtier perspective
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadeva Raya**	**Telugu**	Masterpiece on statecraft and devotion of Andal (Godadevi) to Lord Vishnu

5. Medieval Administration, Taxes & Agrarian Revenue Systems

A. Delhi Sultanate Taxes & Core Economic Terms

- **Jizya**: Religious protection tax levied on non-Muslim subjects (*Zimmis*):
- First levied in India by **Muhammad bin Qasim** in Sindh (712 CE).
- First levied on **Brahmins** as a separate category by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**.
- **Abolished by Akbar in 1564 CE** (also abolished pilgrim tax in 1563).
- **Reimposed by Aurangzeb in 1679 CE**.
- Finally abolished permanently by later Mughal Emperor **Muhammad Shah "Rangeela"** in 1720 on recommendation of Sawai Jai Singh.
- **Zakat**: Religious property tax levied exclusively on well-to-do Muslims (at 2.5% on wealth/savings) dedicated to charity.
- **Kharaj**: General land revenue tax levied on agricultural produce of lands cultivated by non-Muslims (varying between 1/5th to 1/2).
- **Khams**: State's share of **spoils of war / war booty**:
- Islamic Sharia rule: 1/5th to the State Treasury, 4/5th distributed among soldiers.
- **Alauddin Khalji and Muhammad bin Tughlaq reversed this rule**: took **4/5th for the State** and gave only 1/5th to the soldiers! Firoz Tughlaq restored orthodox rule.
- **Haqq-i-Sharb**: **Irrigation tax** (levied at **10% of gross produce**) introduced by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** on peasants using state-constructed canals.
- **Chari & Ghari**: Taxes introduced by **Alauddin Khalji** — *Chari* was grazing tax on milch cattle; *Ghari* was tax on residential houses.
- **Iqta System**: Reorganized and formalized by **Iltutmish**; assignment of land revenue of a territorial tract to nobles/commanders (*Iqtadars / Muqtis / Walis*) in lieu of cash salary, responsible for maintaining troop quotas and remitting surplus (*Fawazil*) to the central treasury.
- **Fawazil**: Excess balance of revenue remitted to the imperial central treasury by an Iqtadar/Muqti after meeting local administrative and military expenses.
- **Sondhar / Taccavi**: Emergency agricultural loans given by state to farmers during famine or distress (pioneered by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** under Diwan-i-Kohi).
- **Karkhanas**: Royal manufacturing workshops; categorized into *Rikabi* (movable/travel) and *Ratibi* (fixed allowances); Firoz Shah Tughlaq maintained 36 giant royal Karkhanas.

B. Mughal Administrative Hierarchy & Key Officers

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Subah (Province) ⟶ Sarkar (District) ⟶ Pargana (Sub-district) ⟶ Deh / Gram (Village)
[Subahdar & Diwan]   [Faujdar & Amil]      [Shiqdar & Amin]        [Muqaddam & Patwari]
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1. Central Administration Officers

Official Designation	Administrative Portfolio / Key Authority	Core Exam Triggers
Wazir / Diwan-i-Ala	**Prime Minister & Head of Revenue / Finance**	Controlled revenue assessment, imperial treasury, expenditure, and provincial Diwans
Mir Bakhshi	**Head of Military Department & Intelligence**	Maintained muster rolls, inspected troops and horses (*Dagh*), issued pay certificates (**Sarkhat**) to Mansabdars
Mir Saman / Khan-i-Saman	**Head of Imperial Household & Karkhanas**	In charge of royal court provisions, imperial stores, internal palace management, state workshops
Sadr-us-Sudur	**Chief Minister of Religious Affairs & Charities**	Administered tax-free land grants (*Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal*), religious endowments, and Islamic law
Qazi-ul-Quzat	**Chief Justice of the Empire**	Highest judicial officer below Emperor; usually held simultaneously by Sadr-us-Sudur
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights**	Checked gambling, wine consumption, maintained correct weights/measures, verified Islamic practices
Mir Atish / Darogha-i-Topkhana	**Chief of Imperial Artillery**	Controlled manufacture, storage, and deployment of cannon topkhana; guarded imperial palace

Official Designation	Administrative Portfolio / Key Authority	Core Exam Triggers
Mir Barr	**Superintendent of Forests and River Navigation**	Maintained imperial boats, timber extraction, royal river flotilla
Waqia-Nawis / Sawani-Nigar	**Imperial News-Reporters & Intelligence Scribes**	Sent confidential intelligence reports from provinces directly to Emperor through Mir Bakhshi

2. Provincial, District & Local Officers

Unit	Officer Designation	Function & Authority
Subah (Province)	**Subahdar / Sipahsalar**	Governor of the Subah; commanded provincial army, maintained law and order
	Provincial Diwan	Independent financial head; reported directly to Central Wazir (kept check on Subahdar)
	Provincial Bakhshi	Maintained muster rolls of provincial mansabdars; acted as chief postal scout (*Waqia-Navis*)
	Kotwal	Police chief of the provincial capital; head of city surveillance, night patrol, and crime
Sarkar (District)	**Faujdar**	Executive and military head of Sarkar; suppressed rebellions, assisted Amil in revenue recovery
	Amil / Amal-Guzar	**Chief Revenue Collector & Assessor** of the district; assisted peasants, assessed crops
	Bitikchi	Chief scribe and accountant of Sarkar; prepared land and revenue assessment records
	Khazandar	District treasurer receiving collections from Parganas
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Shiqdar**	Executive and police officer of Pargana; maintained peace and assisted revenue collection
	Amil / Amin	Revenue assessor and collector at Pargana level
	Fotadar	Treasurer of Pargana
	Qanungo	Hereditary keeper of agrarian revenue records, land measurements, and local customs
Gram / Deh (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Hereditary village headman; collected land revenue from peasants (received 2.5% commission)
	Patwari	Village accountant; maintained village revenue registers (*Bahi*)

C. Mughal Land Classification (Cultivation Frequency)

Categorized in the Ain-i-Akbari based on continuous cultivation:

Land Category	Frequency of Cultivation	Quality / Revenue Status
Polaj (पोलज)	Cultivated **annually and continuously** for each harvest; never allowed to lie fallow	Best quality, most fertile agricultural land; assessed at full revenue
Parauti (परौती)	Left **fallow for 1 or 2 years** to recover soil fertility naturally	Second grade; paid full Polaj rate when brought back under the plough
Chachar (चाचर)	Left **uncultivated / fallow for 3 or 4 years**	Third grade; assessed at lower progressive tax rate to encourage reclamation
Banjar (बंजर)	Uncultivated and barren for **5 or more years**	Lowest grade; charged minimal nominal cess to promote cultivation

D. Mughal Revenue Assessment Methods

System Name	Also Known As	Key Architect / Monarch	Working Mechanism / Key Exam Facts
Zabt / Ain-i-Dahsala	**Todar Mal's Bandobast**	**Raja Todar Mal** under **Akbar (1580 / 24th regnal year)**	Average produce and average market prices of the preceding **10 years (1570–1580)** calculated; state share fixed at **1/3rd (33.3%)** payable in cash. Measured land using **Tanab** (bamboo sticks connected by iron rings replacing hemp ropes) and standardized **Gaz-i-Ilahi** (41 anguls/digits = ~33 inches). Applied across core provinces (North India & Gujarat).
Ghalla-Bakhshi / Batai	Crop-sharing / Bhaoli	Traditional system across India	Physical division of the harvested crop between state and peasant: 1. *Khet-batai*: Division of standing crop in the field before harvest. 2. *Lank-batai*: Division of harvested grain tied in sheaves before thrashing. 3. *Raas-batai*: Division of cleaned grain heap on thrashing floor (most accurate).
Kankut	Danabandi	Traditional appraisal system	Rough estimation and appraisal of standing crop by inspection and pacing the field (*Kan* = grain/estimation, *Kut* = conjecture).
Nasaq	Contractual assessment	Ancient method	Rough lump-sum calculation based on past revenue payments without new annual measurement.

E. Mughal Land Tenure & Jagir Categories

Land Tenure Category	Nature of Ownership / Revenue Rights	Transferability / Legal Condition
Khalisa (खालिसा)	Direct imperial crown land	Revenue deposited directly into the Central Imperial Treasury (*Bait-ul-Mal*)
Tankha Jagir (तनख्वाह जागीर)	Standard revenue assignment in lieu of cash salary	**Strictly transferable** every 3–4 years to prevent local roots/feudal power
Watan Jagir (वतन जागीर)	Homeland territories of autonomous Rajput rulers	**Hereditary and non-transferable**; continued within the royal family
Mashrut Jagir (मशरुत जागीर)	Conditional jagir assigned for a specific post/duty	Subject to temporary fulfillment of specific military/administrative duties
Altamgha Jagir (अल-तमगा जागीर)	Imperial grant initiated by **Jahangir**	**Perpetual, hereditary, irrevocable grant** confirmed with royal vermillion seal
Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal	Charitable land grant for scholars, saints, and religious divines	**Tax-free (*Inam*)** and hereditary; managed by the *Sadr-us-Sudur*
Paibaqi (पायबाकी)	Reserve land tract	Surplus revenue land kept reserved for assignment to upcoming mansabdars

F. Mansabdari System Essentials (Akbar to Aurangzeb)

- **Introduced by Akbar (1571 CE)**: Military-administrative ranking system borrowed from the Mongol decimal system; ranged from rank of 10 to 5,000 (later 7,000 for top royal princes/nobles like Raja Man Singh).
- **Dual Ranks (Zat & Sawar)**:
- **Zat (जात)**: Denoted personal rank, social status, precedence at court, and fixed the personal baseline salary.
- **Sawar (सवार)**: Denoted the actual number of cavalry troops and horses the officer was required to maintain for imperial service.
- **Three Classes of Mansabdars**:
- *Class 1*: Sawar rank = Zat rank.
- *Class 2*: Sawar rank = Half or more of Zat rank.
- *Class 3*: Sawar rank = Less than half of Zat rank.
- **Dah-Bishi Rule (10-20 Rule)**: For every 10 cavalrymen (*Sawars*), the Mansabdar had to maintain **20 horses** (to avoid exhaustion of war mounts during campaigns).
- **Dagh and Chehra**: Instituted by Alauddin Khalji, revived by Sher Shah, and formalized by Akbar:
- *Dagh*: Royal branding of war horses to prevent fraudulent substitution.
- *Chehra / Tashiha*: Descriptive roll / biometric identity of every soldier.
- **Du-aspa Sih-aspa (दो-अस्पा सिह-अस्पा)**: Introduced by **Jahangir**; allowed favored nobles to double their maintained cavalry force and salary allocation **without increasing their base Zat rank**.
- **Month-Scale System (*Mahana*)**: Introduced by **Shah Jahan**; due to divergence between estimated revenue (*Jama*) and actual realization (*Hasil*), Mansabdars were paid on 4-month, 6-month, or 8-month pay scales instead of full 12-month pay.

G. Vijayanagara & South Indian Administrative Systems

- **Nayankara System**:
- Distinctive military-tenurial system of Vijayanagara.
- King was the ultimate owner of all land; granted territories called **Amaram** to military commanders called **Nayakas / Amara-nayakas**.
- Nayakas maintained a fixed quota of foot-soldiers, horses, and elephants for the King and paid an annual tribute into the imperial treasury.
- Documented in detail by Portuguese travelers **Domingo Paes** and **Fernao Nuniz**.
- **Ayagar System**:
- Unique village autonomous administrative organization in South India.
- Every village was an autonomous unit managed by a council of **12 hereditary functionaries** called **Ayagars** (Headman/Gaud, Accountant/Karnam, Blacksmith, Carpenter, Washerman, Barber, etc.).
- Ayagars were granted hereditary tax-free plots of land called **Manyam** and received customary grain shares from the villagers.
- **Key Vijayanagara Administrative Terms**:
- **Athavana (अठवण)**: Central land revenue department.

- **Kandachara (कंदाचार)**: Military department presided over by the *Dandanayaka* (Commander-in-Chief).
- **Sist**: Standard land tax (fixed at 1/6th of gross agricultural yield based on land classification under Krishnadeva Raya).
- **Kavali**: Police duty; fees collected for village policing called *Kaval-katnam*.

6. The Medieval Battle Master Matrix (Chronological Ladder)

Year	Battle Name	Contenders	Victorious Party	Historical Impact / Prelims Takeaway
1191	**First Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan**	Ghori wounded, fled to Ghazni
1192	**Second Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Muhammad Ghori**	Laid the foundation of Muslim rule in North India
1194	**Battle of Chandawar**	Muhammad Ghori vs Jaichand (Gahadavala King of Kannauj)	**Muhammad Ghori**	Kannauj & Banaras annexed; Chandawar near Firozabad (UP)
1526 (21 Apr)	**First Battle of Panipat**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur**	First effective use of **Tulughma** tactic & artillery (*Topkhana*) in North India; Mughal Empire founded
1527 (16 Mar)	**Battle of Khanwa**	Babur vs Rana Sanga of Mewar	**Babur**	Babur declared it **Jihad**; assumed title of **Ghazi**; secured Mughal foothold
1528	**Battle of Chanderi**	Babur vs Medini Rai (Malwa chief)	**Babur**	Rajput women committed Jauhar; Babur captured Malwa forts
1529	**Battle of Ghaghra**	Babur vs Combined Afghan forces under Mahmud Lodi	**Babur**	First battle fought simultaneously on **land and river (water)**
1539 (26 Jun)	**Battle of Chausa**	Sher Khan (Sher Shah) vs Humayun	**Sher Khan**	Near Buxar (Bihar); Humayun saved by water carrier Nizam; Sher Khan took title **Sher Shah**
1540 (17 May)	**Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)**	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	**Sher Shah Suri**	Humayun driven into 15-year exile in Persia; **Second Afghan Empire (Sur Empire)** established
1555	**Battle of Sirhind**	Humayun (led by Bairam Khan) vs Sikandar Shah Suri	**Humayun**	Restored Mughal dynasty in Delhi; Humayun died next year falling down stairs of Sher Mandal library
1556 (5 Nov)	**Second Battle of Panipat**	Akbar (regent Bairam Khan) vs Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)	**Akbar / Bairam Khan**	Hemu struck in eye by stray arrow; captured and beheaded; ended Sur Afghan resistance
1565 (23 Jan)	**Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi / Bannihatti)**	Vijayanagara (Aliya Rama Raya) vs Combined Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar; **Berar absent!**)	**Deccan Sultanates**	Vijayanagara sacked and destroyed; shifted capital to Penukonda & Chandragiri (Aravidu dynasty)
1576 (18 Jun)	**Battle of Haldighati**	Mughal Army (Raja Man Singh of Amber & Asaf Khan) vs Maharana Pratap of Mewar	**Mughal Army** (indecisive strategic outcome)	Chetak (Pratap's horse) became legendary; Pratap continued guerrilla struggle from Kumbhalgarh/Chavand
1658 (15 Apr)	**Battle of Dharmat**	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Imperial Army (Jaswant Singh of Marwar & Qasim Khan)	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ujjain (MP); opened road to Agra
1658 (29 May)	**Battle of Samugarh**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Agra; decisive victory; Aurangzeb imprisoned Shah Jahan in Agra Fort
1659 (Apr)	**Battle of Deorai**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ajmer; Dara captured, humiliated, executed
1761 (14 Jan)	**Third Battle of Panipat**	Marathas (Sadashivrao Bhau & Vishwasrao) vs Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani) & Shuja-ud-Daula (Awadh) & Najib-ud-Daula	**Ahmad Shah Abdali**	Annihilated Maratha leadership; cleared way for British dominance

7. Foreign Travellers & Visiting Rulers (Match the Following Goldmine)

Foreign Traveler	Country of Origin	Period / Century	Indian Ruler / Court Visited	Famous Book / Key Observation
Al-Biruni (Abu Raihan)	Khwarizm (Uzbekistan)	11th c. (1017 CE)	Came with **Mahmud of Ghazni**	***Tahqiq-i-Hind* / *Kitab-ul-Hind***; deep study of Sanskrit, Hindu astronomy, philosophy, and caste system
Ibn Battuta	Tangier (Morocco)	14th c. (1333 CE)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	***Rihla***; served as Qazi of Delhi for 8 years; sent as royal ambassador to China in 1342
Marco Polo	Venice (Italy)	13th c. (1292–94 CE)	**Pandya Kingdom** (Kayal port, King Maravarman Kulasekhara) & **Kakatiya** (Queen Rudramadevi)	*Travels of Marco Polo*; noted flourishing pearl fisheries and horse imports
Nicolo Conti	Venice (Italy)	15th c. (1420 CE)	**Deva Raya I** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	Described Vijayanagara fortifications, festivals of Navaratri and Deepavali
Abdur Razzaq	Herat (Persia)	15th c. (1443 CE)	**Deva Raya II** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	*Matla-us-Sadain*; observed: *"The city is such that eyes has not seen nor ear heard of any place resembling it upon the whole earth"*
Athanasius Nikitin	Tver (Russia)	15th c. (1470–74 CE)	**Bahmani Kingdom** (under Prime Minister Mahmud Gawan & Sultan Muhammad Shah III)	*The Journey Beyond Three Seas*; noted deep contrast between extreme luxury of nobles and wretched poverty of peasants
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	16th c. (1518 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Detailed accounts of Vijayanagara trade, currency, customs, and Sati practice
Domingo Paes	Portugal	16th c. (1520–22 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara)	Described Krishnadeva Raya as *"a monarch who is gentle and wise, full of justice and equity"*; praised Mahanavami Dibba
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal	16th c. (1535–37 CE)	**Achyuta Deva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Horse trader; wrote detailed chronicle on founding of Vijayanagara and women's roles in royal court
Captain William Hawkins	England	1608–1611 CE	**Jahangir**	Reached Surat on *Hector*; spoke Turkish; Jahangir gave him title **"English Khan"** and 400 Mansab
Sir Thomas Roe	England	1615–1619 CE	**Jahangir**	Ambassador of King James I; secured imperial Farman for East India Company factories
Francisco Pelsaert	Netherlands (Dutch)	1620–1627 CE	**Jahangir**	***Remonstrantie***; detailed poverty of artisans and corruption of Mughal governors in Agra
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	France	1640–1667 CE (6 voyages)	**Shah Jahan** & **Aurangzeb**	Professional gem merchant; famous for examining and describing the **Koh-i-Noor** diamond and Peacock Throne
Francois Bernier	France	1656–1668 CE	**Aurangzeb** (Physician to Dara Shikoh)	***Travels in the Mogul Empire***; argued absence of private property in land was cause of India's decline
Niccolao Manucci	Venice (Italy)	1653–1708 CE	**Dara Shikoh** & **Aurangzeb**	***Storia do Mogor***; served as artilleryman for Dara Shikoh; later practiced medicine in Lahore and Madras

8. Bhakti & Sufi Saints & Philosophies (Core Match Matrix)

A. Philosophers & Doctrines

Philosopher Saint	Period / Century	Philosophy / Doctrine	Core Tenet	Mathas / Center
Adi Shankaracharya	8th c. (788–820 CE)	**Advaita** (*Monism / Pure Non-dualism*)	*Brahma Satyam Jagan Mithya* (Brahman alone is real, world is illusion/Maya); Atman is identical to Brahman	Established 4 cardinal Mathas: **Joshimath (Badrikashram, North - Uttarakhand)**, Sringeri (South), Dwarka (West), Puri (East)
Ramanujacharya	11th–12th c. (1017–1137 CE)	**Vishishtadvaita** (*Qualified Non-dualism*)	Atman and world are real attributes (modes) of Brahman (Vishnu); Bhakti is path to Moksha	Srirangam (Tamil Nadu); Sri Vaishnavism

Philosopher Saint	Period / Century	Philosophy / Doctrine	Core Tenet	Mathas / Center
Madhvacharya	13th c. (1199–1278 CE)	**Dvaita** (*Dualism*)	Strict separation between God (Brahman) and individual Soul (Jiva); 5 eternal differences	Udupi (Karnataka); Brahma Sampradaya
Nimbarkacharya	13th c.	**Dvaitadvaita** (*Dualistic Non-dualism / Bhedabheda*)	God, soul, and world are both distinct and non-distinct; Radha-Krishna devotion	Sanaka Sampradaya (Vrindavan)
Vallabhacharya	15th–16th c. (1479–1531 CE)	**Shuddhadvaita** (*Pure Non-dualism*)	World is not an illusion but pure manifestation of Krishna; **Pushti Marga** (Grace of God)	Rudra Sampradaya (Varanasi / Braj)
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	16th c. (1486–1534 CE)	**Achintya Bhedabheda** (*Inconceivable Oneness & Difference*)	Kirtana & Sankirtana movement; ecstatic love for Radha-Krishna	Nadia / Navadvip (Bengal)

A2. North Indian Bhakti saints — Birth and death (do not leave as "15th c." only)

North chain: **Namdev → Ramananda → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu**.

Saint	Birth–death	Place / language	High-yield
Namdev	**c. 1270–1350**	Maharashtra; verses also in Adi Granth	Varkari; Vithoba of Pandharpur
Ramananda	14th–15th c.	Banaras (UP)	Guru of Kabir and Ravidas; Rama-bhakti in the north
Kabir	15th c. (often **1398–1518** in coaching lists)	Born **Kashi / Varanasi**; died **Maghar** (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP)	Nirguna; *Bijak* (Ramaini, Sabda, Sakhi); weaver-saint. **Maghar ≠ Mathura**.
Guru Nanak	**1469–1539**	Talwandi (Nankana Sahib); died Kartarpur	First Sikh Guru; Nirguna; companion **Mardana**
Ravidas	15th–16th c.	Banaras (UP)	Ramananda circle; Dalit saint; verses in Adi Granth
Surdas	**c. 1478–1581**	**Braj** (Mathura–Vrindavan, UP)	Saguna Krishna; *Sursagar*; disciple of **Vallabhacharya**
Tulsidas	**1532–1623**	**Awadhi** belt (Rajapur / Banaras, UP)	*Ramcharitmanas* (Awadhi); Saguna Rama. Do not swap with Surdas.
Mirabai	**c. 1498–1546**	Rajasthan (Mewar) → later Dwarka tradition	Krishna devotee; **not** Andal (Tamil Alvar)
Dadu Dayal	**1544–1603**	Rajasthan	Nirguna; Dadu Panth

> **Logic:** Tulsidas = **Awadhi Rama**. Surdas = **Braj Krishna**. Kabir died at **Maghar**, not Kashi. Nanak **1469–1539**, not a 12th-century Alvar.

B. Sufi Silsilahs (Orders) in India

Silsilah	Prominent Saints	Key Center / Khanqah	Key Feature / Attitude to State
Chishti (Most popular)	**Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer - *Gharib Nawaz*), Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Ajodhan - verses in Guru Granth Sahib), **Nizamuddin Auliya** (*Mehboob-i-Illahi* - saw reigns of 7 Sultans), Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Delhi	Ajmer, Delhi, Punjab	Kept strict distance from royal court; practiced **Sama** (musical recitals) and poverty; vegetarianism
Suhrawardi	**Sheikh Bahauddin Zakariya** (Multan), Hamiduddin Nagori	Multan, Sindh, Bengal	Accepted royal patronage, land grants (*Inam*), and state offices; wealthy lifestyles
Qadiri	Sheikh Abdul Qadir Jilani, Shah Niamatullah, Miyan Mir (laid foundation stone of Golden Temple), **Dara Shikoh** & Jahanara	Punjab, Sindh, Agra	Moderate; Dara Shikoh authored *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*Mingling of Two Oceans*) and translated Upanishads into Persian (*Sirr-i-Akbar*)
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah, **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (*Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani*)	Delhi, Sirhind	Orthodox and puritanical; strictly opposed *Sama*, opposed Akbar's liberal policies; propounded *Wahdat-ul-Shuhud*

9. Marathas & Shivaji's Administration

A. Shivaji's Ashtapradhan Council (Direct Matching Questions)

Member	Designation / Portfolio	Primary Function
1. Peshwa	**Mukhya Pradhan** (Prime Minister)	Overall general administration; represented king in his absence
2. Amatya / Mazumdar	**Finance Minister** / Auditor	Audited all public and military accounts
3. Sachiv / Shurnavis	**Home / Royal Secretary**	Royal correspondence, checked official edicts and sanity of royal accounts
4. Mantri / Waqia-Navis	**Interior Minister / Chronicler**	Recorded daily proceedings of court, intelligence & espionage
5. Senapati / Sari-i-Naubat	**Commander-in-Chief**	Recruitment, military organization, and field operations
6. Sumant / Dabir	**Foreign Minister**	Managed diplomatic relations, embassies, and foreign visitors
7. Nyayadhish	**Chief Justice**	Civil and criminal justice administration
8. Panditrao / Danadhyaksha	**High Priest / Minister for Charities**	Religious affairs, endowments, grants, and penances

> **Note:** All members except **Nyayadhish** and **Panditrao** were required to lead military commands in times of war.

B. Core Maratha Terms

- **Chauth**: Levy of **one-fourth (25%)** of land revenue extracted from neighbouring territories to protect them from Maratha raids.
- **Sardeshmukhi**: Additional **10% levy** claimed by Shivaji in his capacity as hereditary supreme head (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra.
- **Mirasdars**: Hereditary landholders.
- **Bargirs**: Regular cavalry provided with horses and weapons by the state.
- **Silahdars**: Mercenary cavalrymen who brought their own horses and arms.
- **Treaty of Purandar (1665)**: Between Shivaji and Mughal General **Raja Jai Singh I** of Amber; Shivaji surrendered 23 out of 35 forts.
- **Coronation (1674)**: At **Raigad Fort** by pandit **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi; assumed titles **Chhatrapati** and *Haindava Dharmoddharak*.

Topic 1 — Early Medieval India (Regional Kingdoms)

Consolidated — 55 Must-Score Facts

1. Early Medieval India runs roughly **750–1200 CE** after Harsha (हर्ष) as an age of regional kingdoms and hereditary **samantas** (सामंत), not the Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) that begins in **1206**.
2. The **Tripartite Struggle** for **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) was fought by the **Pala**, **Gurjara-Pratihara**, and **Rashtrakuta** (राष्ट्रकूट) powers — not by the Cholas.
3. In the south, imperial power rotated **Pallava** → **Chalukya** → **Rashtrakuta** → **Chola**.
4. The **Pallava** (पल्लव) capital was **Kanchi** (कांची); the **Pandya** capital was **Madurai** (मदुरै).
5. Early Chalukyas ruled from **Badami (बादामी) / Vatapi**; **Eastern Chalukyas** from **Vengi** (**Pedavegi** near **Eluru**, West Godavari (गोदावरी), Andhra); later Western Chalukyas from **Kalyani** — do not merge the three seats.
6. The **Rashtrakuta** capital was **Manyakheta** (Malkhed) in the Deccan (दक्कन).
7. The imperial **Chola** capital moved from **Thanjavur** (तंजावुर) to **Gangaikondacholapuram** under Rajendra I.
8. **Hoysala** power centred on **Halebid / Dvarasamudra**; **Kakatiya** on **Warangal** (वारंगल); **Yadava** on **Devagiri** (देवगिरी) (later Daulatabad).
9. Ruler–dynasty facts: **Mahendravarman** was Pallava; **Kadungon** (कडुंगों) was Pandya; **Amoghavarsha** was Rashtrakuta; **Rajaraja** was Chola.
10. Temple chronology runs **Shore Temple** (शोर मंदिर) (~7th, Pallava Mahabalipuram (महाबलीपुरम)) → **Brihadishwara** (बृहदीश्वर) (**1010**, Rajaraja at Thanjavur) → **Gangaikondacholapuram** (~**1025**, Rajendra).
11. Sena succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) order is **Hemant** → **Vijaya** → **Ballal** → **Lakshman**.
12. Chola administration ran **Mandalam (मंडलम)** → **Valanadu** → **Nadu (नाडु)** → **Village**, and the empire had **four** (चातुर्याम) mandalams at its peak.
13. **Ur** was the ordinary village assembly; **Sabha (सभा) / Mahasabha** was the Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) **agrahara** assembly.
14. The Chola navy struck **Sri Lanka**, the **Maldives**, and **Kadaram (Kedah)**; **Nagapattinam** was a key port (बंदरगाह); the Bay of Bengal was called a "**Chola Lake**."
15. In the Kannauj contest, **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल) backed **Chakrayudha**; **Mihir Bhoja** (मिहिर भोज) recovered the city (~**836**); **Indra (इन्द्र) III** sacked it (**915–918**); **Krishna (कृष्णा) III** pressed again (**963**).
16. **Gopala** was elected Pala founder; **Dharmapala** founded **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला); **Devapala** marked the Pala peak; **Atisha** (अतीश) carried Buddhism (बौद्ध धर्म) toward Tibet.
17. Pratiharas moved from **Bhinmal** to **Kannauj**; **Nagabhatta I** checked the Arabs (अरब); **Mihir Bhoja** took the title **Adivaraha** (आदिवराह).
18. **Mihir Bhoja** (Pratihara (गुर्जर-प्रतिहार), Adivaraha, Kannauj) is not **Bhoja I** of the **Paramaras** at **Dhara** (धारा) in Malwa.
19. **Chandelas** held **Khajuraho (खजुराहो) / Mahoba / Kalinjar (कालिंजर)** in Bundelkhand; **Paramaras** held **Malwa / Dhara**.
20. **Gahadavalas** ruled **Kannauj and Banaras** in the 11th–12th century after Pratihara decline.
21. **Jay Chandra** of the Gahadavalas was killed at **Chandawar** (चंदावर) in **1194**.
22. UP medieval name facts: **Kannauj = Kanyakubja**; **Ayodhya (अयोध्या) = Saketa**; **Varanasi (वाराणसी) = Kashi (काशी) / Avimukta**.
23. **Mahoba** and **Kalinjar** (Banda district) are the Chandela strongholds in Bundelkhand **UP**.
24. **Kalachuris** ruled from **Tripuri** in the Chedi / Dahala belt.
25. **Pulakeshin II** (पुलकेशिन) of Badami defeated Harsha and left the **Aihole** (ऐहोल) prasasti; **Narasimhavarman I** took the title **Vatapikonda**.
26. The poet **Rajasekhara** (राजशेखर) lived at the courts of Pratihara **Mahendrapala I** and **Mahipala I** (*Karpuramanjari* (कर्पूरमंजरी), *Kavyamimamsa*, and related works).
27. Do not confuse **Kannauj (UP)** — the north sovereignty prize — with **Kanchi (TN)**, the Pallava capital.
28. Sena capital under Lakshman Sen is linked with **Nadia**; Pala seats stayed in the Bengal–Bihar belt with only episodic Kannauj holds.
29. Imperial Chola (साम्राज्य चोल) founder is **Vijayalaya** (विजयालय) (~**850**), not Rajaraja or Parantaka. **Parantaka I** took the title **Maduraikonda** after defeating the Madurai king.
30. **Battle of Takkolam (949)** — Rashtrakuta **Krishna III** led a confederacy that killed Chola prince **Rajaditya** (son of Parantaka I) and broke Chola power for a generation.
31. **Rajaraja I** (राजराज) created the standing **naval** arm, smashed the Chera fleet at **Kandalloor**, took **northern** Sri Lanka, and built **Brihadishwara** with its colossal **Nandi**.

32. **Rajendra I** took **whole Sri Lanka** (prisoner **Mahendra V**), defeated Pala **Mahipala**, founded **Gangaikondacholapuram**, built the artificial lake **Chola Gangam**, and made the Bay of Bengal a "**Chola Lake**."
33. Under **Kulottunga I**, a Chola Buddhist / merchant mission of **72** traders went to **China (1077)**; he accepted Sinhala independence under **Vijayabahu** and married a daughter to prince **Virapperumal**.
34. Chola village boards (**Variyam**): **Thotta** = gardens; **Samvatsara** = annual; **Eri** = tanks; **Pon** = gold / finance. **Uttaramerur** is the Sabha working-system inscription.
35. **Eripatti** (एरिपट्टी) = land whose revenue maintains the village tank. **Taniyur** (तनियूर) = a very large village administered as a single unit (not a Brahmana gift). **Ghatika** = temple-attached college.
36. Chola **Nataraja** (नटराज) bronzes show the dancing Shiva with **four** hands; **Dakshinamurti** (दक्षिणामूर्ति) is Shiva as **teacher**, installed facing **south**.
37. Pallava **Simhavishnu** took the title **Avanisimha**; **Narasimhavarman I** is **Mahamalla** / **Vatapikonda** and sent naval help to Ceylon (**642**); **Mahendravarman I** (महेन्द्रवर्मन) wrote *Mattavilasa Prahasana (प्रहसन)* (मत्तविलास प्रहसन).
38. **Pulakeshin I** founded the Badami / Vatapi Chalukya house. **Aihole** prasasti of **Ravikirti** names **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि). Chalukyas appointed **women** to high office (**Vijaya Bhattarika**).
39. **Kadamba** capital was **Vanavasi**; founder **Mayurasharman**; the state was annexed by **Pulakeshin II**. Chera capital memory is **Vanchi / Karuvur**.
40. **Meenakshi** (मीनाक्षी) temple at Madurai is linked in tradition to **Kulasekara Pandya** (later rebuilt under Nayakas). **Motupalli** was the Kakatiya overseas port (Marco Polo).
41. Cholas commonly designated a **Yuvraj** (heir) during the reigning king's lifetime.
42. Sailendra / Srivijaya expedition under **Rajaraja I** and especially **Rajendra I** answered trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) obstruction toward China.
43. **Prithviraj (पृथ्वीराज) III** (Ajmer (अजमेर) Chauhan) won **First Tarain (तराइन) (1191)** and lost **Second Tarain (1192)** to Muhammad Ghori. **Vigraharaja IV** earlier took **Delhi** from the Tomaras.
44. **Anangpal Tomar** founded **Dhillika (Delhi)** in the 8th century as a Pratihara feudatory. **Jejakabhukti** (जेजाकभुक्ति) = ancient **Bundelkhand** (from Jeja / Jayashakti, Chandela).
45. Pala facts: **Gopala** (elected; **Odantapuri** (उदंतपुरी)); **Dharmapala** (**Vikramashila**, **Somapura / Paharpur**; title **Paramasaugata**); **Devapala** granted five villages for the **Sailendra / Balaputradeva** Nalanda (नालंदा) vihara (विहार).
46. **Kumaradevi** (queen of Govind Chandra Gahadavala) built the **Dharmachakra (धर्मचक्र) Jaina Vihara** at **Sarnath** (सारनाथ). **Lakshmidhara** wrote *Krityakalpataru*.
47. **Alha (आल्हा)–Udal** of **Mahoba** served Chandela **Parmardi / Paramardi**; struggle with Prithviraj appears in Chand Bardai's *Prithviraj Raso* (पृथ्वीराज रासो) and Jagnik's *Alha-khand* (*Parmal Raso*).
48. Kannauj medieval names include **Kanyakubja**, **Mahodaya**, and **Mahodaya Shri / Nagar Mahoday Shri**. **Koil** = Aligarh (अलीगढ़); **Mahotsava Nagar** = Mahoba.
49. **Paramara** power centre moved from **Ujjain** (उज्जैन) to **Dhara**. **Bhoja** wrote *Samarangana Sutradhara (सूत्रधार)* (architecture / devices) and founded **Bhojshala** (Saraswati (सरस्वती); Sanskrit school at Dhar, **1035**).
50. **Solanki / Chaulukya** capital was **Anhilwada** (अणहिलवाड़); founder line **Mularaja I**. Jain scholar **Hemachandra** advised **Kumarapala** (after fame under Jayasimha Siddharaja).
51. **Lakshmana Sena** started **Lakshmana Samvat**. Early medieval jurists are **Vijnaneshwara** (विज्ञानेश्वर) (*Mitakshara* (मिताक्षरा)), **Jimutavahana** (जीमूतवाहन) (*Dayabhaga* (दायाभाग)), and **Hemadri** — not **Rajasekhara** (poet).
52. **Dantidurga** founded Rashtrakutas and performed **Hiranyagarbha** at Ujjain. **Amoghavarsha I** (अमोघवर्ष) was born in a military camp on the Narmada (नर्मदा) during Govinda III's northern return.
53. **Gangeyadeva** (Kalachuri of Tripuri) took the title **Vikramaditya** (विक्रमादित्य) and revived **gold** coinage; **Al-Biruni** mentions him and Tripuri.
54. *Hammira Mahakavya* (महाकाव्य) treats Chauhans as **Suryavanshi** / Agnikula. *Hammir Raso* (हम्मीर रासो) is by **Sharangadeva** (not Abdur Rehman). *Prithviraja Vijaya* (विजय) is by **Jayanaka**.
55. **Pundravardhana bhukti (भुक्ति)** was in **north Bengal** (later into north Bihar under Pala–Chandra–Sena). **Araghatta** = Persian-wheel style water device for irrigation.

📋 Must-score facts — dynasty, capital, temple, UP tags

Dynasty ↔ capital

Dynasty	Capital / seat
Pallava	**Kanchi**

Dynasty	Capital / seat
Pandya	**Madurai**
Early Chalukya (प्राचीन चालुक्य)	**Badami / Vatapi**
Eastern Chalukya	**Vengi**
Western Chalukya (पश्चिमी चालुक्य)	**Kalyani**
Rashtrakuta	**Manyakheta (Malkhed)**
Imperial Chola	**Thanjavur → Gangaikondacholapuram** (Rajendra)
Hoysala	**Halebid / Dvarasamudra**
Kakatiya	**Warangal**
Yadava	**Devagiri** (later Daulatabad)
Gurjara-Pratihara	**Bhinmal → Kannauj**
Pala	Bengal–Bihar belt (episodic Kannauj)
Chandela	**Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar**
Paramara	**Malwa / Dhara**
Gahadavala	**Kannauj + Banaras**
Kalachuri	**Tripuri**
Kadamba	**Vanavasi**
Solanki / Chaulukya	**Anhilwada**

Ruler ↔ dynasty tag

Ruler	Tag
Mahendravarman I	Pallava; *Mattavilasa Prahasana*
Narasimhavarman I	Pallava; **Vatapikonda / Mahamalla**
Pulakeshin II	Badami Chalukya; Harsha defeat; **Aihole** prasasti
Dantidurga	Rashtrakuta founder; **Hiranyagarbha**
Amoghavarsha I	Rashtrakuta
Vijayalaya	Imperial Chola founder (~**850**)
Rajaraja I	Chola navy; **Brihadishwara 1010**
Rajendra I	**Gangaikondachola** (गंगैकोंडचोल); whole Lanka; Chola Lake
Gopala	Pala founder (elected)
Dharmapala	**Vikramashila**; Paramasaugata
Mihir Bhoja	Pratihara; **Adivaraha**
Bhoja (Paramara) (परमार भोज)	Malwa / Dhara scholar-king
Jay Chandra	Gahadavala; killed **Chandawar 1194**

Temple / event ↔ year

Item	Year / lock
Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)	~7th c., Pallava
Brihadishwara (Thanjavur)	**1010**, Rajaraja
Gangaikondacholapuram temple	~**1025**, Rajendra
Battle of Takkolam	**949** (Krishna III vs Cholas)
First Tarain	**1191** (Prithviraj wins)
Second Tarain	**1192** (Ghori wins)
Chandawar	**1194** (Jay Chandra dies)

UP medieval name tags

Modern	Medieval name
Kannauj	**Kanyakubja / Mahodaya**
Ayodhya	**Saketa**
Varanasi	**Kashi / Avimukta**
Mahoba	**Mahotsava Nagar** (Chandela)
Aligarh	**Koil**

Topic 2 — Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. In **712**, Arab **Muhammad bin Qasim** took **Sindh** from **Dahir** (**Chachnama**; capital **Arod**); this was an Indus (सिंधु) foothold, not Gangetic conquest.
2. **Sind 712** Cause–Course–Result: Arab push for Indus ports → Qasim took Debal and killed Dahir → Multan–Sindh foothold only, no Gangetic empire.
3. **Alptigin** founded the **Ghaznavid (ग़ज़नवी) (Yamini)** dynasty at **Ghazni**; **Mahmud** (**998**) led about **17** raids, plundered **Somnath** (सोमनाथ) under **Bhimdev I**, and usually **raided and withdrew**.
4. **Somnath ~1025/26** Cause–Course–Result: temple plunder prestige → Mahmud stormed the shrine → **Bhimdev I** later rebuilt; no lasting Gujarat annexation.
5. **Utbi** was Mahmud's court historian (**Kitab-ul-Yamini** / **Tarikh-i-Yamini**); **Firdausi** (फिरदौसी) wrote **Shahnama**; **Al-Biruni** wrote **Kitab-ul-Hind / Tahqiq-i-Hind** and was the first Muslim to study the **Puranas**.
6. **Muhammad Ghori** practised **territorial conquest** — governors, garrisons, and coinage — unlike Mahmud's raid-and-return pattern. His **first defeat in India** was near **Mount Abu (1178)** by **Naika Devi** (नायका देवी) (regent for **Mularaja II / Bhimdev II**).
7. **First Tarain (1191)** Cause–Course–Result: Ghori sought the Delhi–Ajmer corridor → Prithviraj (पृथ्वीराज) broke the Ghurid left and Ghori fled wounded → no pursuit, so the **1192** rematch followed.
8. **Second Tarain (1192)** Cause–Course–Result: Ghori returned stronger → feigned retreat and archery captured Prithviraj near Sirsa → Ajmer–Delhi fell and Turkish garrisons stayed (unlike Mahmud's raids).
9. **Chandawar (1194)** Cause–Course–Result: after Tarain, Kannauj (कन्नौज) still blocked the upper Ganga → Ghori killed **Jay Chandra** near **Firozabad (Yamuna (यमुना))** → the upper Ganga valley opened to Ghurid agents.
10. At **First Panipat (1526) Babur (बाबर)** defeated **Ibrahim Lodi** and ended the Delhi Sultanate.
11. Five dynasties span **1206–1526**: **Slave 1206–1290** → **Khalji 1290–1320** → **Tughlaq 1320–1414** → **Sayyid 1414–1451** → **Lodi 1451–1526**.
12. **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** ruled from **Lahore (1206–10)** as **Malik/Sipahsalar** (not "Sultan"), was called **Lakh Baksh / Quran Khwan**, and died playing **chaugan**.
13. **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश) (**1210–1236**), **Ilbari** "slave of a slave," made **Delhi** the capital, coined **tanka/jital**, took Caliph's **khilat (1229)**, organised the **Turkan-i-Chahalgani (Forty)**, and refused asylum to **Jalaluddin Mingburni**.
14. **Razia** (रजिया) (**1236–1240**) was the **only woman Sultan** of Delhi; **Altunia (Bhatinda)** and anger over **Yaqut** ended her rule.
15. **Balban** used **Blood and Iron** (लौह एवं रक्त की नीति), **Zil-i-Ilahi / Niyabat-i-Khudai** (ज़िल्ल-ए-इलाही / नियाबत-ए-ख़ुदाई), **Sijda (सिजदा)/Paibos** (सिजदा / पैबोस), **Nawruz** (नौरोज़), and **Diwan-i-Arz** (दीवान-ए-अर्ध - सैन्य विभाग) (**Imad-ul-Mulk**); the Slave line closed with weak **Kaiqubad** and infant **Kayumars** before the **1290 Khalji coup**.
16. **Jalaluddin Khalji** (**1290–1296**) founded the dynasty, was crowned at **Kilokhari**, and was killed by Alauddin at **Kara**.
17. **Alauddin Khalji** kept a cash-paid standing army (सेना) and used **Dagh** (दाग़ - horse branding) and **Chehra (चेहरा) / Huliya** (चेहरा / हुलिया - soldier descriptive rolls) against fake musters.
18. Alauddin's four revolt ordinances hit noble gifts and land grants, widened intelligence, banned wine and gambling, and curbed free noble feasts and intermarriage.
19. Alauddin's north–Deccan (दक्कन) conquest order is **Gujarat 1299** → **Ranthambor 1301** → **Chittor (चित्तौड़) 1303** → **Malwa** → **Devagiri** → **Warangal (वारंगल)** → **Dwarasamudra** → **Madurai**; **Malik Kafur** rose from Cambay.
20. Alauddin took about **50%** by measurement (**Diwan-i-Mustakharaj** (दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज) / दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज - arrears dept), added **Ghari/Charai** (घरी / चराई कर), built **Siri**, used **Sikandar-i-Sani** (सिकंदर-ए-सानी - second Alexander (सिकंदर)), and died in **1316**; **Malik Kafur** = **Hazar-Dinari** (हज़ार दिनारी).
21. **Shahna-i-Mandi** (शहना-ए-मंडी - market controller) was Alauddin's market controller; **Amir-i-Kohi** (अमीर-ए-कोही / दीवान-ए-कोही) was Muhammad bin Tughlaq's agriculture department — do not swap them.
22. **Ghazi Malik / Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (**1320–1325**) killed usurper **Khusrau Khan**, founded the Tughlaqs, and built **Tughlaqabad**; he did **not** build Qutub Minar.
23. **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक) was the most learned Sultan; his main experiments were **Daulatabad**, **token currency** (सांकेतिक मुद्रा), **Amir-i-Kohi**, Doab (दोआब) tax, and Khurasan/Qarachil plans; **Ibn Battuta** (इब्न बतूता) wrote *Rihla* (रिहला).
24. **Firoz Shah** built canals and levied **Haqq-i-Sharb** (हक़-ए-शर्ब - irrigation tax), ran **Diwan-i-Khairat** (दीवान-ए-ख़ैरात - charity) / **Bandagan** (दीवान-ए-बंदगान - slaves) and **Dar-ul-Shafa** (दार-उल-शफ़ा - charitable hospital), funded Haj from the treasury,

moved Ashoka (अशोक) pillars (**Topra/Meerut (मेरठ)**), used **Azizuddin Khan** for Nagarkot texts, made **iqta (इक्ता) hereditary** (इक्ता वंशानुगत), and put **jizya (जज़िया) on Brahmins** (जज़िया).

25. **Khizr Khan** (**1414–1421**) founded the **Sayyid** house as Timur's Multan–Delhi nominee (**Rayat-i-Ala** style); **Alam Shah** abdicated to **Bahlul Lodi** in **1451**.
26. **Bahlul Lodi** founded the first **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty, issued the **Bahluli** coin, and annexed **Sharqi Jaunpur (1484)**; **Sikandar Lodi** built up **Agra** (आगरा) and used **Gaz-i-Sikandari**; **Ibrahim Lodi** (**1517–1526**) was the last Delhi Sultan.
27. **Iltutmish** institutionalised the **Iqta** (इक्ता) system in India; **Siyasatnama** (निजाम-उल-मुल्क) (Nizam-ul-Mulk (निजाम-उल-मुल्क)) is the classical source on Muqti duties; Iqta revenue went to the **Muqti** (मुक़्ती / वली), not directly to the Sultan; **Khalsa** (ख़ालिसा) was crown land.
28. **Khams** (ख़म्स) was one-fifth of war booty; **jizya** (जज़िया) was the tax on non-Muslims.
29. Admin facts: **Diwan-i-Insha** (दीवान-ए-इंशा) = correspondence; **Diwan-i-Tan** (दीवान-ए-तन) = salaries/jagirs; **Mustarfi** (मुस्तौफ़ी) = audit; **Mushrif** (मुशरिफ़) = accounts/records; **Vakianvis** (वाक़ियानवीस) = firmans/events list; **Khareetadar** (खरीतादार) = despatch of decrees.
30. **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** is by **Barani** (बरनी) (or **Afif** for Firoz's reign alone); **Tughlaqnama** (तुग़लक़नामा) is by **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो), not Ibn Battuta; **Rihla** is Ibn Battuta's travel book.
31. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** is by **Minhaj**; Amir Khusrau wrote **Khazain-ul-Futuh** and **Khaliq-e-Bari**; **Rag Vibodh** (राग विबोध) is **Somnath's** music treatise (**1609**), not Khusrau's.
32. Architecture facts: **Sultan Garhi** = Iltutmish; **Red Palace** = Balban; **Jamat Khana** = Alauddin; **Dhai Din Ka Jhopra** = Aibak; **Tughlaqabad** = Ghiyasuddin; **Hauz Khas** = Firoz.
33. **Qutub (कुतुब) Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) was started by Aibak and finished by Iltutmish; **Firuz** repaired the fourth storey and added the fifth; **Alai Darwaza** (अलाई दरवाज़ा) is Alauddin's gateway of **1311**.
34. **Bakhtiyar Khalji** took **Odantapuri** (उदंतपुरी), destroyed **Nalanda** (नालंदा) and **Vikramshila** (विक्रमशिला), took **Nadia** (~**1204**), and made **Lakhnauti** his capital; **Lakshmana Sena** fled to East Bengal.
35. Ghori's coins (रूपक) show **Goddess Lakshmi** with Arabic **Kalma**; Mahmud issued bilingual silver (रूपक) with Sanskrit **"Avyaktamekam Muhammad Avatar Nripati Mahmud"**.
36. After Tarain, Ghori granted the first Indian **iqta** charge to **Qutbuddin Aibak** (कुतुबुद्दीन ऐबक) (**Kuhram** and **Samana**); **Iltutmish** later made Iqta the Sultanate's regular framework; **Timur** sacked Delhi in **1398**.
37. UP facts: **Chandawar 1194**; **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) annexed **1484**; **Kol (Aligarh (अलीगढ़))** garrison; do not confuse **Sikandar (Agra)** with **Ibrahim (Panipat 1526)**.
38. Turkish success rested on Rajput (राजपूत) **disunity** after Pratihara (गुर्जर-प्रतिहार) decline — Chauhans, Gahadavalas, Chandelas (**Vidyadhar** alone held Mahmud in **1019–20**), and Paramaras fought separately.
39. Ghaznavids **raided**; Ghurids **conquered and stayed** — that contrast is the first Turkish-invasion trap. **Firdausi ≠ Firishta (फरिश्ता)** (Shahnama vs Bijapur (बीजापुर) chronicle).
40. Longest Sultanate house is often **Tughlaq**; shortest major house is often **Khalji**; first Afghan house is **Lodi**.
41. **Mubarak Shah Khalji** declared himself **Khalifa** and relaxed Alauddin's controls; **Khusrau Khan**'s brief usurpation ended with Ghazi Malik's victory (**1320**).
42. **Yahiya Sirhindi**'s *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi* is the main Sayyid-age chronicle; **Mubarakabad** on the Yamuna is Mubarak Shah Sayyid's city, not a Khalji monument.

📋 Must-score facts — battles, dynasties, admin tags

Battle ↔ year

Battle	Year	Lock
Mount Abu (Naika Devi)	**1178**	Ghori's first India defeat
First Tarain	**1191**	Prithviraj wins
Second Tarain	**1192**	Ghori wins
Chandawar	**1194**	Jay Chandra killed (Yamuna / Firozabad)
First Panipat	**1526**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi
Timur sack of Delhi	**1398**	Late Tughlaq crisis

Dynasty chronology

Dynasty	Span
Slave (Mamluk)	**1206–1290**
Khalji	**1290–1320**
Tughlaq	**1320–1414**
Sayyid	**1414–1451**
Lodi	**1451–1526**

Sultan ↔ tag

Sultan	Tag
Aibak	**Lahore**; Lakh Baksh; chaugan death; started Qutub
Iltutmish	Delhi capital; **tanka/jital**; Iqta; Caliph **1229**
Razia	Only woman Sultan; Altunia / Yaqut
Balban	Blood and Iron; Sijda/Paibos; Diwan-i-Arz
Alauddin	Dagh/Chehra; market control; Siri; Alai Darwaza **1311**
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Daulatabad; token currency; Amir-i-Kohi; Ibn Battuta
Firoz Shah	Canals; Haqq-i-Sharb; hereditary iqta; jizya on Brahmins
Sikandar Lodi	Built up **Agra**
Ibrahim Lodi	Last Delhi Sultan; Panipat **1526**

Admin / architecture match

Term	Lock
Iqta	Revenue assignment to **Muqti** (Iltutmish)
Khalsa	Crown land
Shahna-i-Mandi	Alauddin market controller
Amir-i-Kohi	Muhammad bin Tughlaq agriculture dept
Dhai Din Ka Jhopra	**Aibak**
Sultan Garhi	**Iltutmish**
Alai Darwaza	**Alauddin, 1311**
Qutub Minar	Aibak start → Iltutmish finish

Topic 3 — Regional Kingdoms (Sharqi, Kashmir, Vijayanagara, Bahmani & Deccan)

Consolidated — 36 Must-Score Facts

1. **Firuz Shah** founded the city of **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) in memory of cousin **Jauna Khan (Muhammad bin Tughlaq (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक))**; **Malik Sarwar (Khwaja-i-Jahan / Malik-us-Sharq)** made it independent (**~1394**); **Ibrahim (इब्राहिम) Shah** made it **Siraj/Shiraz-i-Hind**.
2. **Atala Masjid** (अटाला मस्जिद) and **Lal Darwaza Masjid** are classic **Sharqi** (शर्की) monuments at Jaunpur in eastern **UP**.
3. Last Sharqi ruler **Hussain Shah** fell to **Bahlul Lodi** (**1479/1484** keys); **Vidyapati**'s *Kirtilata* praises Jaunpur under Ibrahim.
4. **Malik Muhammad Jaisi** composed **Padmavat** (पद्मावत) in the Jaunpur cultural circle.
5. **Zain-ul-Abidin** (**1420–1470**), called **Bud Shah**, abolished **jaziya** and cow slaughter and restored temples in Kashmir.
6. **Sriya Bhatt** was Zain-ul-Abidin's Hindu minister; **Zaina Lanka** was his island palace on **Wular Lake**.
7. **Sikandar Shah** of Kashmir is the temple-destruction contrast (**Butshikan**) to tolerant **Zain-ul-Abidin**.
8. **Vijayanagara** (विजयनगर) was founded in **1336** by **Harihara I** and **Bukka I** (Sangama) with capital at **Hampi** (हम्पी) on the Tungabhadra (तुंगभद्रा); tradition links guidance to **Vidyaranya**.
9. Vijayanagara dynasties ran **Sangama** → **Saluva** → **Tuluva** → **Aravidu**.
10. **Deva Raya I / II** mark Sangama military peak against Bahmani; **Saluva Narasimha** founded the Saluva house; **Krishnadevaraya** (कृष्णदेवराय) (**1509–1529**, Tuluva) wrote **Amuktamalyada** (आमुक्तमाल्यदा) and patronised the **Ashtadiggajas**.
11. Vijayanagara used the **Nayankara / amara** system and celebrated the **Mahanavami** festival; do not equate Nayankara with Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) **iqta** (इक्ता).
12. **Bahmani** was founded in **1347** by **Hasan Gangu** as **Alauddin Bahman Shah**; the capital moved **Gulbarga** → **Bidar**.
13. Bahmani politics pitted **Afaqis (foreigners)** against **Deccanis (locals)**; **Mahmud Gawan** (Afaqi wazir) wrote **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (रियाज-उल-इंशा), organised **eight tarafs**, and was executed in **1481**.
14. After **1518** Bahmani split into five Deccan Sultanates: **Bijapur (बीजापुर), Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, and Berar**.
15. **Bijapur (Adil Shahi)** holds **Gol Gumbaz (गोल गुम्बद) / Gol Gumbad** (tomb of **Muhammad Adil Shah**; among the world's largest domes); **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** (**Jagatguru / Ablababa**) wrote **Kitab-i-Nauras** (किताब-ए-नौरस), founded **Nauraspur**; **Firishta** (फरिश्ता) worked at his court.
16. **Golkonda (Qutb (कुतुब) Shahi)** later centred on **Hyderabad** (हैदराबाद); **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah** fell to Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब) in **1687**.
17. **Ahmadnagar** = Nizam (निजाम) Shahi; **Bidar** = Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक) Shahi; **Berar** = Imad Shahi.
18. **Talikota (1565)** Cause–Course–Result: Rama Raya (रामा राय)'s Deccan overreach after Krishnadevaraya → Deccan alliance crushed Vijayanagara at Rakkasa-Tangadi (**23 Jan 1565**) → **Hampi** sacked and the empire ceased to be a great power.
19. **Raichur (1520)** was a **Krishnadevaraya** victory — do not confuse it with Talikota **1565**.
20. **Riyaz-ul-Insha** is Gawan's letters; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** (रियाज-उस-सलातीन) is Bengal history (इतिहास) — never swap the two.
21. **Tin Darwaza** stands at **Bidar Fort**, not Ahmedabad (अहमदाबाद); Ahmedabad's gate is **Teen Darwaza**. **Lal Darwaza–Jaunpur** is correctly matched.
22. Among these regional states, only **Sharqi Jaunpur** has its capital in modern **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश).
23. Chronology spine: Vijayanagara **1336** → Bahmani **1347** → Sharqi **1394** → Zain-ul-Abidin **1420–1470** → Gawan executed **1481** → Jaunpur annexed **1484** → Bahmani split **1518** → Talikota **1565**.
24. **Vitthala Temple** at Hampi is Vijayanagara; **Charminar** (चारमीनार) is Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.
25. **Kitab-i-Nauras** is Bijapur (Ibrahim Adil Shah II); **Amuktamalyada** is Krishnadevaraya's Telugu epic.
26. **Manucharitramu** by **Allasani Peddana** belongs to Krishnadevaraya's Ashtadiggajas circle.
27. **Burhan-e-Masir** is an Ahmadnagar chronicle; **Mirat-e-Sikandari** is a Gujarat narrative.
28. **Muzaffar Shah (1407)** founded Gujarat; **Mahmud Begada** took **Champaner** and **Girnar**; **Bahadur Shah** conceded **Diu** to the Portuguese.
29. **Yusuf Adil Shah** founded **Bijapur**; **Malik Ahmad** founded **Ahmadnagar** — do not swap founders.
30. **Jami Masjid (Jaunpur)** joins Atala and Lal Darwaza in the Sharqi UP monument set.
31. Vijayanagara–Bahmani rivalry centred on the **Raichur Doab** and Krishna–Tungabhadra frontier long before Talikota.
32. Deccan Sultanate common pattern used Persianate courts with local Telugu/Marathi/Kannada intermediaries under the five successor houses.
33. **Abul Hasan Tana Shah** is the last Qutb Shah memory paired with Aurangzeb's **1687** Golkonda annexation.

34. **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi**'s cultural peak (**Siraj-i-Hind**) is the UP Sharqi identity line before Lodi annexation.
35. **Chand Bibi** of Ahmadnagar is the Deccan defence memory against Akbar's late campaigns — do not place her at Talikota **1565**.
36. Post-Talikota Aravidu rulers shifted power southward; Hampi ceased to be the imperial capital after the **1565** sack.

📋 Must-score facts — capitals, books, chronology

State ↔ capital / founder

State	Capital / founder lock
Sharqi	**Jaunpur**; independent by **Malik Sarwar (~1394)**
Vijayanagara	**Hampi**; **Harihara–Bukka 1336** (Sangama)
Bahmani	**Gulbarga → Bidar**; **Hasan Gangu 1347**
Bijapur	**Adil Shahi**; Gol Gumbaz
Golkonda	**Qutb Shahi**; later Hyderabad
Ahmadnagar	**Nizam Shahi**
Bidar	**Barid Shahi**
Berar	**Imad Shahi**
Gujarat Sultanate	Founded **Muzaffar Shah (1407)**

Book / monument ↔ context

Item	Lock
Atala / Lal Darwaza Masjid	**Sharqi Jaunpur (UP)**
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadevaraya** (Telugu)
Kitab-i-Nauras	**Ibrahim Adil Shah II** (Bijapur)
Riyaz-ul-Insha	**Mahmud Gawan** letters
Riyaz-us-Salatin	**Bengal** history (not Gawan)
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi** (Jaunpur circle)
Vitthala Temple	Vijayanagara **Hampi**
Charminar	Qutb Shahi **Hyderabad**
Tin Darwaza	**Bidar Fort** (not Ahmedabad Teen Darwaza)

Chronology spine

Event	Year
Vijayanagara founded	**1336**
Bahmani founded	**1347**
Sharqi independent	**~1394**
Zain-ul-Abidin (Bud Shah)	**1420–1470**
Gawan executed	**1481**
Jaunpur annexed (Lodi)	**1479 / 1484**
Bahmani split (5 Deccan states)	**1518**
Raichur (Krishnadevaraya win)	**1520**
Talikota	**1565**

Vijayanagara dynasty order

Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu

Topic 4 — Bhakti & Sufi Movements

Consolidated — 36 Must-Score Facts

1. Southern Bhakti began with **Nayanars (नायनार) (Shiva)** and **Alvars (आलवार) (Vishnu)** in **7th–12th** century Tamil land, before the north Indian sant wave.
2. The north chain runs roughly **Namdev** → **Ramananda** → **Kabir** → **Nanak** → **Chaitanya** → **Surdas** → **Tulsidas**.
3. **Saguna** (सगुण) bhakti worships a formed deity such as Rama or Krishna (कृष्ण); **Nirguna** (निर्गुण) worships the formless One (Kabir, Nanak).
4. Guru–disciple facts: **Kabir** (कबीर) and **Ravidas** under **Ramananda**; **Surdas** under **Vallabhacharya** (शुद्धाद्वैत); **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) under **Nizamuddin Auliya**; **Mardana** (मरदाना) under **Guru Nanak** (गुरु नानक).
5. Saint chronology: **Namdev** (नामदेव) (~1270–1350) → **Kabir** (15th c.) → **Nanak** (1469–1539) → **Chaitanya** (चैतन्य) (1486–1533).
6. Later saints: **Surdas** (1478–1581) → **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) (1532–1623) → **Dadu Dayal** (1544–1603).
7. The **Chishti** line runs **Moinuddin** → **Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki** → **Baba Farid** → **Nizamuddin** → **Nasiruddin Chiragh**, stressing poverty, **sama** (समा), and ziyarat.
8. Great Chishti shrines include **Ajmer** (अजमेर), **Delhi (Nizamuddin)**, **Ajodhan (Farid)**, **Nagaur**, and **Pakpattan**.
9. **Suhrawardi** saints of Multan accepted state wealth; **Naqshbandi** reformers under **Ahmad Sirhindi** opposed syncretism.
10. **Qadiri** order entered India later (famous Multan–Uch and Deccan links); do not merge it with Chishti poverty or Suhrawardi office-holding.
11. **Ramcharitmanas** (रामचरितमानस) is Tulsidas in **Awadhi** (अवधी); **Sursagar** (सूरसागर) is Surdas in **Braj** (ब्रज).
12. **Fawaid-ul-Fuad** records **Nizamuddin** conversations compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**, not by Amir Khusrau.
13. Vedanta schools: **Shankara (शंकराचार्य)–Advaita (अद्वैत)**; **Ramanuja (रामानुजाचार्य)–Vishishtadvaita (विशिष्टाद्वैत)**; **Madhva–Dvaita (द्वैत)**; **Nimbarka (द्वैताद्वैत)–Dvaitadvaita (द्वैताद्वैत)**; **Vallabhacharya–Shuddhadvaita (शुद्धाद्वैत)**.
14. **Ramananda** (born **Prayag** (प्रयाग), ~1299) taught Rama bhakti in **Hindi** first among north sants; do not confuse with south **Ramanuja** (Vishishtadvaita).
15. **Basavanna** led Lingayat / Virashaiva reform in Karnataka with **Ishtalinga**, Kayaka, and Anubhava Mantapa.
16. The **Varkari** tradition centres on **Pandharpur / Vithoba** through **Jnaneshwar** (ज्ञानेश्वरी), Namdev, and Tukaram (तुकाराम).
17. **Jayadeva** wrote **Gita Govinda** (गीत गोविंद) in Odisha; **Shankaradeva** led Assam Vaishnavism (वैष्णव) with **satra** and **kirtana-ghosha**.
18. UP Kabir facts: **Bijak** (बीजक) (Ramaini/Sabda/Sakhi); dialogues with **Dharamdas** = *Amarmul* (अमरमूल); death at **Maghar** (Sant Kabir Nagar).
19. **Tulsidas** belongs to Awadhi **UP**; **Surdas** to the **Braj** belt (Mathura (मथुरा)–Vrindavan (वृंदावन)); **Gorakhnath** to **Gorakhpur** (गोरखपुर).
20. **Nath / Nathpanthi** yogis under **Gorakhnath** stress Hatha yoga and guru lineage; they are distinct from north nirguna sants and from Chishti Sufis.
21. **Mirabai** (मीराबाई) is the Rajasthan Krishna devotee; **Andal** (आंडाल) is the Tamil Alvar (आलवार) woman saint — do not swap them.
22. **Chaitanya** of Bengal taught **Gaudiya Vaishnavism** with **sankirtan** and ecstatic Krishna bhakti; do not merge him with Kabir's nirguna line.
23. **Guru Nanak** taught **Ik Onkar**, the householder path, **langar**, and **sangat**; he founded Sikhism, not a Kabirpanth offshoot.
24. **Baba Farid** was the Chishti saint of Ajodhan with verses in the **Adi Granth** (आदि ग्रंथ); he is not Kabir.
25. **Chishti** orders rejected state wealth; **Suhrawardi** accepted patronage and office.
26. A **pir** (पीर) is the Sufi spiritual master; a **guru** is the Bhakti preceptor.
27. **Narsi Mehta** belongs to Gujarat; **Namdev** is an early Vithoba / Varkari saint.
28. Bhakti was mainly **intra-Hindu** reform against empty ritual (कर्मकांड), not a movement "against Islam," though it shared social space with Sufism.
29. **Moinuddin** (disciple of **Usman Haruni**) settled **Ajmer**; order name from **Chisht (Afghanistan)** (चिश्ती), not a village in Ajmer. **Bahauddin Zakariya** = **Multan** (Suhrawardi).
30. **Ravidas** is the Banaras Dalit (दलित) saint in Ramananda's circle.
31. Composite culture does not mean every saint mixed doctrines — **Ahmad Sirhindi** and **Kabir** rejected syncretic ritual.
32. Regional map: **Jayadeva** (Odisha), **Shankaradeva** / Ekasarana (**Kamarupa–Assam**), **Basavanna** (Karnataka). **Prem Vatika** (प्रेम वाटिका) = **Raskhan**; **Barahmasa** = **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** (मलिक मुहम्मद जायसी); **Dewa Sharif** (देवा शरीफ) (Barabanki) = Haji

Waris Ali Shah (हाजी वारिस अली शाह).

33. **Ulema** are sharia scholars; a **Shaikh** is the authorised Sufi guide — do not treat every ulema as a silsilah pir.
34. **Firdausi / Firdausi order** memory in Bihar (Yahya Maneri line) is separate from the Delhi–Ajmer **Chishti** core.
35. **Dadu Dayal** of Rajasthan taught nirguna devotion after Kabir's generation; keep him after Surdas–Tulsidas in the later sant list.
36. **Akka Mahadevi** (Kannada Virashaiva woman saint) pairs with Basavanna's Karnataka reform, not with Mirabai's Rajasthan Krishna bhakti.

📋 Must-score facts — saints, silsilah, Vedanta

Saint ↔ region / work

Saint	Lock
Nayanars	Tamil **Shiva** devotees
Alvars	Tamil **Vishnu** devotees
Ramananda	North Rama bhakti; **Prayag** birth; Hindi
Kabir	Nirguna; **Bijak**; death **Maghar**
Nanak	Sikh founder; Ik Onkar
Surdas	**Braj**; *Sursagar*; Vallabh disciple
Tulsidas	**Awadhi**; *Ramcharitmanas*
Chaitanya	Bengal Gaudiya Vaishnavism
Mirabai	Rajasthan Krishna devotee
Andal	Tamil **Alvar** (आलवार) woman saint
Basavanna	Karnataka **Lingayat**
Jayadeva	Odisha; *Gita Govinda*
Shankaradeva	Assam; satra / kirtana-ghosha
Ravidas	Banaras; Ramananda circle

Guru ↔ disciple

Guru	Disciple
Ramananda	Kabir; Ravidas
Vallabhacharya	Surdas
Nizamuddin Auliya	Amir Khusrau
Guru Nanak	Mardana (rababi companion)

Master Table — Major Sufi Silsilas in India (प्रमुख सूफी सिलसिले)

(Tested heavily in match-the-pair, saints, centres, and doctrinal practices)

Silsila (सिलसिला)	Indian Founder(s)	Main Centres / Khanqah	Key Saints (पीर / शेख)	Doctrinal Stance & State Relations
Chishti (चिश्ती)	**Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti** (arrived 1192 with Ghori)	**Ajmer** (Rajasthan), Delhi, Nagaur, Pakpattan, Daulatabad, Gulbarga	• **Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki** (Delhi; Qutb Minar dedicated to him) • **Baba Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar** (Ajodhan/Pakpattan; verses in Guru Granth Sahib) • **Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya** (*Mahbub-i-Ilahi*; Delhi; saw reign of 7 Sultans; Yogic pranayama master / *Siddha*) • **Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Dehli** (last great Chishti of Delhi) • **Shaikh Salim Chishti** (Fatehpur Sikri; Akbar's spiritual guide) • **Burhanuddin Gharib** (introduced Chishti order in Deccan; **Daulatabad**, 1309) • **Khwaja Gesudaraz Banda Nawaz** (**Gulbarga**; author of *Miraj-ul-Ashiqin*)	• **Poverty, simplicity, service to mankind** • Kept **strict aloofness from state patronage and wealth** • Practiced **Sama (समा)** — spiritual musical gatherings to attain ecstasy • Embraced *Wahdat-ul-Wujud* (Unity of Being / Pantheism)
Suhrawardi (सुहरावर्दी)	**Shaikh Bahauddin Zakariya** (1170–1262)	**Multan** & Uchh (Punjab / Sindh)	• **Bahauddin Zakariya** (given title *Shaikh-ul-Islam* by Iltutmish) • **Shaikh Ruknuddin Abul Fath** (grandson of Zakariya; patronized by Alauddin & Tughlaqs) • Jalaluddin Surkh-Posh Bukhari	• **Accepted state titles, jagirs, and royal patronage** • Did not believe in extreme poverty or fasting • Rejected *Sama* music; strictly adhered to orthodox Sharia
Naqshbandi (नक़्शबंदी)	**Khwaja Baqi Billah** (1563–1603)	Delhi, Sirhind (Punjab)	• **Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (*Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani* — Reformer of the Second Millennium; imprisoned by Jahangir at Gwalior) • Khwaja Muhammad Masum • **Shah Waliullah Dehlawi** (18th c. synthesizer)	• **Most orthodox and puritanical order** • Vehemently opposed Akbar's syncretic *Sulh-i-Kul* and *Din-i-Ilahi* • Formulated *Wahdat-ul-Shuhud* (Unity of Appearance) against *Wahdat-ul-Wujud* • **Strictly banned musical gatherings (Sama)**; practiced silent remembrance (*Zikr-i-Khafi*)
Qadiri (कादिरी)	**Shah Niamatullah** & **Sayyid Muhammad Ghaus** (mid-15th c.)	Uchh (Sindh), Multan, Agra, Lahore	• **Shaikh Mir Muhammad (Mian Mir)** of Lahore (laid foundation stone of Golden Temple, Amritsar) • **Mullah Shah Badakhshi** (spiritual guru of **Dara Shikoh** and **Jahanara**) • Dara Shikoh authored *Safinat-ul-Auliya* and *Sakinat-ul-Auliya* on Qadiri saints	• Moderate, orthodox yet tolerant • Dara Shikoh translated 50 Upanishads into Persian as ***Sirr-i-Akbar*** under Qadiri influence • Practiced loud remembrance (*Zikr-i-Jali*)
Shattari (शत्तारी)	**Shah Abdullah Shattari** (d. 1472)	Jaunpur, Malwa, Bengal, **Gwalior**	• **Shaikh Muhammad Ghaus of Gwalior** (author of *Jawahir-i-Khamsa*; deep master of Yogic occult sciences; guru of **Tansen**; patronized by Humayun)	• Believed in direct, instantaneous spiritual attainment (*Shattar* = lightning speed) • Synthesized Islamic Sufism with Hindu Hatha Yoga and Tantra
Firdausi (फ़िरदौसी)	**Shaikh Badruddin Samarqandi** (branch of Suhrawardi)	**Bihar** (Maner, Rajgir, Patna)	• **Shaikh Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri** (*Makhdum-ul-Mulk*; famous for *Maktubat-i-Sadi* / Hundred Letters on spiritual guidance)	• Active almost exclusively in **Bihar** • Emphasized social justice, humanitarian service, and spiritual letters

Master Table — Essential Sufi Literature & Cross-Cultural Translations

(Tested directly in UPPCS 2018 Q90, 2021 Q101)

Book / Text Title	Author / Compiler	Subject / Nature of Work	High-Yield Exam Takeaway
Fawa'id-ul-Fu'ad (फ़वाइद-उल-फ़ुआद)	**Amir Hasan Sijzi** (the "Saadi of India")	Record of conversations and table-talks (*Malfuzat*) of **Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya**	Pioneer of the *Malfuzat* genre; shows daily life, ethics, and teachings in Delhi Sultanate
Amritakunda* → *Hauz al-Hayat (हौज़ अल-हयात)	Translated into Arabic/Persian by **Rukn-ud-din Samarqandi**	Sanskrit Yogic treatise on Hatha Yoga, breath control (*Pranayama*), and chakras	Proof of deep Yogic influence on Chishti Sufis; Nizamuddin Auliya praised yogic practices and was called *Siddha* (UPPCS 2018 Q90)
Kashf-ul-Mahjub (कश्फ़-उल-महजूब)	**Ali Hujwiri** (*Data Ganj Bakhsh*, Lahore)	Earliest formal Persian treatise on Sufi doctrine, principles, and hagiography	Oldest Sufi text composed in the Indian subcontinent
Siyar-ul-Auliya (सियर-उल-औलिया)	**Sayyid Muhammad Mubarak Kirmani (Mir Khwurd)**	Comprehensive biography and history of the Chishti saints of India	Standard authentic narrative for Chishti silsila genealogy
Miraj-ul-Ashiqin (मेराज-उल-आशिक़ीन)	**Khwaja Gesudaraz Banda Nawaz** of Gulbarga	Mystical Islamic treatise on divine love and spiritual stations	Earliest known prose work in **Dakhani Urdu**
Jawahir-i-Khamsa (जवाहिरे खम्सा)	**Shaikh Muhammad Ghaus of Gwalior**	Five Jewels of mystical practice, incantations, and esoteric sciences	Integrated Yogic mudras with Sufi meditation; used by Humayun

Vedanta school ↔ founder

School	Founder
Advaita	**Shankara**
Vishishtadvaita	**Ramanuja**
Dvaita	**Madhva**
Dvaitadvaita	**Nimbarka** (निंबार्क)
Shuddhadvaita	**Vallabhacharya**

Saint chronology (north)

Namdev (~1270–1350) → Kabir (15th c.) → Nanak (1469–1539) → Chaitanya (1486–1533) → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu

Topic 5 — Medieval Literature

Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. The court language of the Sultanate and Mughal empires was **Persian**; **Baburnama** (बाबरनामा) alone is written in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**.
2. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** is by **Minhaj-us-Siraj**; **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** is by **Ziauddin Barani**.
3. **Tughlaqnama** (तुग़लक़नामा) is by **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) (his last historical masnavi, 1320); **Rihla** (रिहला) is **Ibn Battuta (इब्न बतूता)'s** travelogue.
4. **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** is Barani's political theory text, not a narrative history (इतिहास).
5. Both **Barani** (बरनी) and **Shams-i-Siraj Afif** wrote works titled **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** for different periods of Firuz's age.
6. **Taj-ul-Maasir** is by Hasan Nizami; **Kitab-ul-Hind** is by **Alberuni**.
7. **Amir Khusrau** wrote **Khamsa**, **Nuh Sipihr**, **Miftah-ul-Futuh**, **Khazain-ul-Futuh**, and **Ashiqa** (आशिक़ा); **Rag Vibodh** (राग विबोध) was written by **Somnath** (सोमनाथ) (1609).
8. **Miftah-ul-Futuh** covers Jalaluddin Khalji (खिलजी); **Khazain-ul-Futuh** covers Alauddin — keep the Khalji pair straight.
9. Vernacular & treatise matches: **Mulla Daud–Chandayan**; **Damodar (दामोदर) Kavi–Padmavati Katha (पद्मावती कथा)**; **Amir Khusrau–Ashiqa**; **Somnath–Rag Vibodh**.
10. **Padmavat** (पद्मावत) is **Malik Muhammad Jaisi's** Awadhi (अवधी) epic — not Damodar Kavi's Padmavati Katha.
11. **Baburnama** = Babur (बाबर); **Humayunnama** = Gulbadan Begum; **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** (तुज़ुक-ए-जहाँगीरी) = Jahangir (जहाँगीर)'s own memoir.
12. **Akbarnama** is Abul Fazl (अबुल फजल)'s narrative history; **Ain-i-Akbari** (आइन-ए-अकबरी) is his admin gazetteer, not a biography.
13. **Padshahnama** (पादशाहनामा) = Abdul Hamid Lahori (Shah Jahan (शाहजहाँ)); **Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh** = Badauni, who was critical of Akbar (अकबर).
14. Death chronology: **Faizi (फैजी) (1595)** → **Sheikh Mubarak (1597)** → **Abul Fazl murdered (1602)** → **Daniyal (1604)**.
15. Regional Persian facts: **Mirat-e-Sikandari** = Gujarat; **Burhan-e-Masir** = Ahmadnagar; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** (रियाज़-उस-सलातीन) = Bengal; **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (रियाज़-उल-इंशा) = Gawan's letters.
16. **Tutinama** is by **Nakhshabi**, not by Amir Khusrau.
17. **Amir Khusrau** belongs to the Sultanate age; do not place him in the Akbar–Tansen (तानसेन) court.
18. **Alamgirnama** is by Mirza Muhammad Kazim (Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)); **Futuh-us-Salatin** is by Abdul Malik Isami.
19. **Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi** is Firuz Shah's own regulations — not Barani's **Fatawa-i-Jahandari**.
20. **Tarikh** (तारीख) means continuous annals; **tabaqat** (तबक़ात) means generational "classes" of biographies.
21. UP literary facts: **Jaisi–Padmavat** and **Mulla Daud–Chandayan** for Awadhi / Hindavi romance.
22. **Hindavi** bridge literature is especially associated with Amir Khusrau.
23. **Badauni** stands for hostile historiography; **Abul Fazl** (अबुल फजल) stands for official panegyric under Akbar.
24. Akbar's (अकबर) translation peak rendered the Mahabharata (**Razmnama** (रज्मनामा)), Ramayana (रामायण), and related texts into Persian with Faizi's circle.
25. **Gulbadan Begum** is a rare female voice in Mughal prose through **Humayunnama**.
26. Court Persian ran from **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश) through **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) as the main administrative literary language.
27. Vernacular Bhakti (भक्ति) poetry of Kabir (कबीर), Tulsidas (तुलसीदास), and Surdas (सूरदास) ran parallel to Persian court literature.
28. **Afif** covers later Firuz; Barani's Tarikh stops earlier — that period split is the double-title trap.

📋 Must-score facts — book ↔ author

Sultanate chronicles

Book	Author
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj**
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	**Barani** (also **Afif** for later Firuz)
Tughlaqnama	**Barani** (this chapter's lock; do not pair with Ibn Battuta)
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	**Barani** (political theory)
Taj-ul-Maasir	**Hasan Nizami**

Book	Author
Kitab-ul-Hind	**Alberuni**
Rihla	**Ibn Battuta**
Khazain-ul-Futuh	**Amir Khusrau** (Alauddin)
Miftah-ul-Futuh	**Amir Khusrau** (Jalaluddin Khalji)
Rag Vibodh	**Somnath** (सोमनाथ) (1609 music treatise)
Futuh-us-Salatin	**Isami**
Tutinama	**Nakhshabi** (not Khusrau)

Mughal texts

Book	Author
Baburnama	**Babur** (बाबर) (**Chagatai Turki**)
Humayunnama	**Gulbadan Begum**
Akbarnama	**Abul Fazl** (narrative)
Ain-i-Akbari	**Abul Fazl** (gazetteer)
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	**Jahangir** (जहाँगीर) (own memoir)
Padshahnama	**Abdul Hamid Lahori** (Shah Jahan)
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	**Badauni**
Alamgirnama	**Mirza Muhammad Kazim**

Vernacular / regional

Book	Author / region
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi** (Awadhi)
Chandayan	**Mulla Daud**
Padmavati Katha	**Damodar Kavi** (not Jaisi)
Mirat-e-Sikandari	Gujarat
Burhan-e-Masir	Ahmadnagar
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Bengal
Riyaz-ul-Insha	**Gawan** letters

Death chronology (Akbar circle)

Faizi 1595 → Sheikh Mubarak 1597 → Abul Fazl murdered 1602 → Daniyal 1604

Topic 7 — Mughal Empire

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. **Babur** (बाबर) founded the Mughal empire after defeating **Ibrahim (इब्राहिम) Lodi** at the **First Battle of Panipat (पानीपत)** on **21 April 1526** (GC; also cited as 20 April), using **Tulughma** flanking and **Araba** cart-forts.
2. **Panipat I (1526)** Cause–Course–Result: divided Afghan nobles vs Babur's claim → Tulughma + Araba + guns broke Lodi's mass → Ibrahim killed and the Delhi Sultanate ended.
3. At **Khanwa (खानवा) in 1527**, Babur defeated **Rana Sanga (सांगा)**'s Rajput confederacy; **Chanderi 1528** and **Ghagra 1529** followed against Medini Rai (राई) and eastern Afghans.
4. **Khanwa (1527)** Cause–Course–Result: Sanga's post-Panipat confederacy → Babur's artillery and cart-forts → Rajput challenge to the early Mughal core crushed.
5. **Baburnama** (बाबरनामा) (Tuzk-e-Babri) was written in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**, not Persian; the Mughal **court language** was **Persian** (फ़ारसी).
6. The Mughals were **Chagatai** Turks (तुर्क) (from **Chinggis Khan's second son**); Babur took **Padshah** at **Kabul (1504)**, not only after Panipat (पानीपत).
7. **Alam Khan** (आलम खान) was Ibrahim Lodi's uncle and a throne pretender; **Daulat Khan** (दौलत खान), **Dilawar Khan**, and **Rana Sanga** also invited Babur.
8. Tomb fact: **Babur–Kabul**, **Humayun–Delhi**, **Akbar–Sikandra**, **Jahangir–Lahore**, and **Shah Jahan–Agra** (Taj for Mumtaz).
9. Humayun lost **Chausa (चौसा) in 1539** and **Kannauj (कन्नौज)/Bilgram (बिलग्राम) in 1540** to Sher Shah (शेरशाह), returned in **1555**, and died in **1556**.
10. **Daurah (दौराह) (1532)** was Humayun versus Afghan chiefs; do not confuse it with **Dharmat (धर्मत) (April 1658)**, Aurangzeb versus Jaswant Singh.
11. Battle chronology fact: **Daurah 1532 → Chausa 1539 → Kannauj 1540 → Samugarh (समुगढ़) 1658**.
12. At the **Second Battle of Panipat on 5 November 1556**, Akbar and **Bairam Khan** (बैरम खान) defeated **Hemu** and secured the throne.
13. **Panipat II (1556)** Cause–Course–Result: Hemu seized Delhi after Humayun's death → Bairam's army struck Hemu near Panipat → Akbar's throne secured and Sur-Afghan bid collapsed.
14. **Bairam Khan** received the title **Khan-i-Khana** from **Akbar** (अकबर) — only that statement is true; the claim that the title came when he was appointed Vazir (वक़ील) is false.
15. Akbar's **mansabdari** (मनसबदारी व्यवस्था) used dual ranks **zat** (जात - personal rank/pay) and **sawar** (सवार - cavalry quota); salary came from rotated **jagir** (जागीर) or cash; the system was **not hereditary** (गैर-वंशानुगत).
16. Centre offices: **Wakil/Vazir**, **Diwan-i-Wizarat** (finance), **Mir Bakhshi** (army/mansabs), **Sadr-us-Sudur**, **Mir Saman**, **Diwan-i-Insha**; provinces ran **Suba → Sarkar → Pargana → village** with dual **Subahdar** and **Diwan**.
17. **Todar Mal**'s **zabt** (ज़ब्ती - measurement-based assessment) measured land for a cash demand; **dahsala (1580–81)** (दहसाला बंदोबस्त) used a **10-year average** of yield and price.
18. Akbar continued Sher Shah's coinage: silver (रूपक) **rupiya** (रुपिया), copper **dam** (दाम - about **1/40** of a rupiya), and gold **mohur** (मोहर).
19. Akbar's expansion order: **Malwa (1561–62) → Chittor (1567–68) → Gujarat (1572–73) → Bengal after Tukaroi (1575–76) → Kashmir (1586)** plus Kabul–Sind–Deccan beginnings.
20. **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) at Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी) commemorates the **Gujarat victory of 1572**, not Jahangir's birth.
21. Akbar made **Fatehpur Sikri** (फतेहपुर सीकरी) capital about **1571–85** and built **Allahabad (इलाहाबाद)/Ilahabad fort in 1583**; **Ibadat Khana** debates began about **1575**.
22. Akbar's **Rajput policy** began with the **1562** Amber marriage (**Harkha / Jodha Bai**); loyal rajas took mansabs; **Man Singh** (~**7000** zat) fought at **Haldighati 1576**.
23. **Sulh-i-Kul** (सुलह-ए-कुल - universal peace / concord) was Akbar's universal peace policy; **Din-i-Ilahi (1582)** (दीन-ए-इलाही) remained only a small court circle (**Birbal** joined).
24. Akbar abolished **jizya (जज़िया) in 1564** (जज़िया कर); Aurangzeb **reimposed** it in **1679**.
25. Court death order: **Sheikh Mubarak 1593 → Faizi 1595 → Abul Fazl murdered 1602 → Daniyal 1605**.
26. **Abul Fazl** wrote *Akbarnama* and *Ain-i-Akbari* (आइन-ए-अकबरी); **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana** translated Baburnama into Persian; **Tansen** and **Birbal** were Navratnas.

27. Painting spine: Humayun's Safavid contact → Akbar's **Hamzanama / Akbarnama** kitabkhana → Jahangir's naturalism (**Ustad Mansur**) → Shah Jahan albums → Aurangzeb cut patronage and artists moved to Rajput–Deccan courts.
28. **Nur Jahan** (नूरजहाँ) (Mehr-un-Nisa) married Jahangir in **1611**, appeared on coins and farmans, and patronised **Itimad-ud-Daula's** Agra tomb (early pietra dura); Jahangir remained emperor.
29. **William Hawkins (हॉकिन्स)** reached Jahangir in **1608** speaking Turkish; **Sir Thomas Roe (रो)** stayed at court **1615–19**.
30. Shah Jahan's **Nahr-i-Bihisht** in Shahjahanabad drew water from the restored **Firuz Rajabwah**; **Taj Mahal** and **Red Fort / Jama Masjid** mark his architecture peak.
31. **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati (सरस्वती)** of Banaras was patronised by **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ).
32. Aurangzeb succession order: **Shuja beaten near Banaras** → **Dharmat April 1658** → **Samugarh May 1658** → **Deorai 1659**.
33. Aurangzeb annexed **Bijapur (बीजापुर) in 1686** and **Golkonda in 1687**; the last Qutb (कुतुब) Shah was **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah**.
34. **Jajau in 1707** came after Aurangzeb's death, when Bahadur Shah I (बहादुर शाह I) defeated Azam Shah.
35. Akbar organised about **12 subahs**; under Aurangzeb the empire reached about **21 subahs**.
36. **Hamida Banu** was Humayun's wife; **Gulbadan** wrote *Humayunnama*.
37. **Dara Shikoh** (दारा शिकोह) wrote *Majma-ul-Bahrain* and *Sirr-i-Akbar*; Aurangzeb had him killed in **1659**.
38. Later Mughals: **Bahadur Shah I** wins **Jajau 1707**; **Sayyid (सैयद) Brothers** (सैय्यद) under **Farrukhsiyar** (फ़र्रुख़); **Muhammad Shah Rangeela (रंगीला)** faces **Nadir Shah (नादिर शाह) at Karnal 1739**; last emperor **Bahadur Shah II Zafar (ज़फ़र)** in **1857**.
39. **Maham Anaga** built **Khayr-ul-Manazil** near Purana Qila in early Akbar years — not a Sher Shah monument.
40. **Panch Mahal** is the five-storey Sikri palace; do not confuse it with **Buland Darwaza** (Gujarat victory gate).
41. **Shah Jahan's Balkh–Badakhshan (1646–47)** was a prestige failure; do not treat it as equal to Aurangzeb's Deccan annexations.
42. **Khalsa** (ख़ालिसा) under Mughals means crown land; **jagir** is the assigned revenue unit of a mansabdar — keep both distinct from Sikh **Khalsa (1699)**.

📋 Must-score facts — battles, tombs, admin

Battle ↔ year

Battle	Year	Lock
First Panipat	**1526**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi
Khanwa	**1527**	Babur vs **Rana Sanga**
Chanderi	**1528**	Babur vs Medini Rai
Ghagra	**1529**	Babur vs eastern Afghans
Daurah	**1532**	Humayun vs Afghan chiefs
Chausa	**1539**	Sher Shah; Humayun escapes
Kannauj / Bilgram	**1540**	Sher Shah decisive
Second Panipat	**1556**	Akbar–Bairam vs **Hemu**
Dharmat	**Apr 1658**	Aurangzeb vs Jaswant Singh
Samugarh	**May 1658**	Aurangzeb vs Dara
Deorai	**1659**	Aurangzeb succession close
Jajau	**1707**	Bahadur Shah I vs Azam

Tomb ↔ place

Emperor	Tomb
Babur	**Kabul**
Humayun	**Delhi**
Jahangir	**Lahore**
Shah Jahan	**Agra** (आगरा)

Admin / policy tags

Term	Lock
Mansabdari	Dual **zat + sawar**; not hereditary
Zabt	Measurement-based cash demand (**Todar Mal**)
Dahsala	**10-year** average (**1580–81**)
Rupiya / Dam / Mohur	Silver / copper (~1/40) / gold
Sulh-i-Kul	Universal peace policy
Din-i-Ilahi	**1582** small court circle
Jizya	Abolished **1564**; reimposed **1679**
Buland Darwaza	Gujarat victory **1572** (not Jahangir birth)

Court death order

Sheikh Mubarak → Faizi → Abul Fazl (1602) → Daniyal

Topic 8 — Sher Shah Suri

Consolidated — 25 Must-Score Facts

1. **Farid Khan** (फरीद खान) of **Sasaram** (सासाराम) became **Sher Khan** (शेर खान) after the tiger-kill tradition, then **Sher Shah Suri** as Padshah from **1540**.
2. The Sur empire lasted only about **1540–1545**, yet its admin, roads, and revenue model shaped later Mughal (मुग़ल) practice.
3. At **Chausa (चौसा) on 26 June 1539**, Sher Shah defeated Humayun (हुमायूँ), who escaped across the Ganga (गंगा) on a mashak.
4. At **Kannauj (कन्नौज)/Bilgram (बिलग्राम) on 17 May 1540**, Sher Shah won decisively and Humayun fled into exile.
5. **Daurah (दौराह) (1532)** was Humayun versus Afghan chiefs; it is **not** Sher Shah's Chausa battle.
6. Chronology fact: **Daurah 1532 → Chausa 1539 → Kannauj 1540 → Samugarh (समुगढ़) 1658**.
7. Sher Shah died in **May 1545** at the **Kalinjar** (कालिंजर) siege from a **gunpowder** blast; his tomb is the lake mausoleum at **Sasaram**.
8. Successor **Islam Shah (Jalal Khan)** ruled **1545–1553**; Humayun returned to Delhi–Agra in **1555**.
9. Each pargana (परगना) had a **Shiqdar** (शिक़दार) for law and order, a **Munsif** (मुंसिफ़) for accounts and justice, and an **Amil/Desai** (आमिल / देसाई) for collection.
10. **Jarib** (जरीब) is the **measuring rope** used to fix the bigha; it is **not** a tax. Taxes included **Jaribana** (जरीबाना - survey fee) and **Muhasilana** (मुहसिलाना - tax collection fee). **Desai** is the revenue collector.
11. Land was classed good, middle, or bad; **rai** (राय) was the crop rate per **bigha**; **zabt** (ज़ब्ती) fixed an annual cash demand.
12. The state issued a **patta** (पट्टा - title deed) to the peasant; **qabuliat** (क़बूलियत - acceptance agreement) was the peasant's written acceptance.
13. **Todar Mal** (टोडर मल) trained under Sher Shah's revenue system before carrying measurement practice into Akbar (अकबर)'s court.
14. The **Grand Trunk Road** (सड़क-ए-आज़म) ran from **Sonargaon** in Bengal to **Peshawar**, with **sarais** (सराय) about every **12 kos**.
15. Currency fact: silver (रूपक) **rupiya** (रुपिया - ~178 grains), copper **dam** (दाम - ~1/40 of a rupiya), and gold **mohur** (मोहर); Akbar continued the **dam**.
16. Key forts include **Rohtas** (रोहतास) in Bihar against Humayun's return and **Purana (पुराण) Qila** (पुराना किला) in Delhi.
17. At **Sammel/Giri-Sumel in 1544**, Sher Shah fought **Rao Maldeo Rathore of Marwar (मारवाड़)**.
18. **Jayata and Kumpa** were loyal **Marwar** Rathore captains who died fighting; they were **not** Mewar (मेवाड़) warriors.
19. Centre offices: **Diwan-i-Wazarat** (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत) for finance, **Diwan-i-Ariz** (दीवान-ए-अर्ज़) for the army (सेना), and **Diwan-i-Risalat** (दीवान-ए-रसालत) for grants.
20. Monument order places **Sher Shah's Sasaram tomb** after Atala Jaunpur (जौनपुर) and before Humayun's tomb at Delhi.
21. **Barid** (बरीद - spy) watched officers; the **qazi** (क़ाज़ी) judged by sharia and stayed outside the revenue chain.
22. Horses were branded with **dagh** (दाग़) and soldiers with **chehra** (चेहरा / हुलिया), a precursor to the later Mughal chehra–dagh system.
23. Sher Shah kept a standing force with registered men; he did **not** create hereditary mansabdari (मनसबदारी व्यवस्था) like Akbar.
24. **Farid Khan** was educated at **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) (**Siraj-i-Hind**). He took **Hazrat-e-Ala** (हज़रत-ए-आला) in Bengal service, then **Sher Shah** (शेरशाह) after **Chausa (1539)**.
25. **Khayr-ul-Manazil** near Purana Qila was built by **Maham Anaga** in Akbar's era, not by Sher Shah. **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque stands **inside** Purana Qila — Sher Shah's work.

📋 Must-score facts — battles, revenue, roads

Battle / event ↔ year

Event	Year	Lock
Daurah	**1532**	Humayun vs Afghans (not Sher Shah)
Chausa	**26 June 1539**	Humayun escapes on mashak
Kannauj / Bilgram	**17 May 1540**	Humayun exile begins
Sammel / Giri-Sumel	**1544**	vs Rao Maldeo (Marwar)
Kalinjar death	**May 1545**	Gunpowder blast

Event	Year	Lock
Islam Shah	**1545–1553**	Successor
Humayun return	**1555**	Delhi–Agra recovered

Revenue / office tags

Term	Lock
Jarib	Measuring **rope** (not a tax)
Rai	Crop rate per **bigha**
Zabt	Annual cash demand
Patta	State document to peasant
Qabuliat	Peasant's written acceptance
Shiqdar	Law and order (pargana)
Munshif (मुंशिफ)	Accounts
Amil / Desai	Collection
Dagh	Horse branding

Roads / currency / forts

Item	Lock
Grand Trunk Road	**Sonargaon** → **Peshawar**; sarais ~12 kos
Rupiya	Silver (~178 grains)
Dam	Copper; ~**1/40** rupiya
Mohur	Gold
Rohtas	Bihar fort vs Humayun return
Purana Qila	Delhi citadel (दुर्ग); **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque
Sasaram tomb	Lake mausoleum; birth + burial

Name ladder

Farid Khan → Sher Khan → Sher Shah (Padshah from 1540)

Topic 9 — Rajputs

Consolidated — 24 Must-Score Facts

1. **Sisodia** ruled **Mewar** (Chittor (चित्तौड़) → Udaipur (उदयपुर)); **Rathore** ruled **Marwar** (मारवाड़) (Jodhpur); **Kachhwaha** ruled **Amber/Jaipur**.
2. Title fact: **Maharana/Rana** for Mewar; **Rao** for Marwar and Bikaner.
3. At **Khanwa (खानवा) on 16 March 1527**, Babur (बाबर) defeated **Rana Sanga**'s confederacy; never pair **Pratap** with Khanwa.
4. **Maharana Pratap**, son of Udai Singh II, refused Akbar (अकबर)'s mansab (मनसब) and held out from Aravalli (अरावली) bases such as **Kumbhalgarh** and **Gogunda**.
5. At **Haldighati on 18 June 1576**, Pratap faced **Raja (राजा) Man Singh** (राजा मान सिंह) of Amber; **Akbar was not** present in the pass.
6. Haldighati was tactically indecisive; Pratap escaped, fought a guerrilla war, and died in **1597**.
7. Pratap's son **Amar Singh** made peace with **Jahangir (जहाँगीर) in 1615**, keeping Mewar honour without personal court attendance.
8. **Alauddin** sacked **Chittor in 1303**; **Akbar** (अकबर) took it in **1567–68** after Jaimal–Patta (पट्टा) resistance and jauhar (जौहर).
9. Alauddin conquest order: **Gujarat 1299** → **Ranthambore (रणथंभौर) 1301** → **Chittor 1303** → **Warangal (वारंगल) ~1310**.
10. **Udaipur** became Mewar capital from **1559**, while **Chittor** remained the prestige fort.
11. **Rana Hamir (हमीर)** belongs to **Mewar**; **Rana Chunda** (राणा चुंडा) is also Mewar, while **Rao Chunda** (राव चुंडा) is the **Marwar** line.
12. **Rana Hammir (मेवाड़ हमीर) (c. 1326)** restored Mewar after the Khalji (खिलजी) sack; he is **not Hamir Deva (रणथम्भौर हमीर)** of Ranthambore (died 1301).
13. **Vijay Stambha** (विजय स्तम्भ) is **Kumbha** (कुम्भा)'s victory tower; **Kirti Stambha** (कीर्ति स्तम्भ) is the older Jain tower — both stand at Chittor.
14. **Jayata and Kumpa** fought for **Marwar** against Sher Shah (शेरशाह) at Sammel in **1544**.
15. **Jauhar** is women's immolation at a falling fort; **saka** (साका) is the warriors' last charge.
16. Pratap's allies included **Bhils under Punja** and Afghan commander **Hakim Khan Sur**.
17. Other states: **Bhati–Jaisalmer**, **Hada–Bundi–Kota**, and **Bikaner** as a Rathore branch.
18. **Rao Jodha** founded **Jodhpur in 1459**.
19. After Akbar, most Rajput houses took mansabs; **Man Singh** (मान सिंह) of Amber held about **7000** zat (जात) and fought at Haldighati.
20. **Malik Sarwar** founded **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर), not Malwa — a common distractor beside ruler–state match lists.
21. Khanwa sits near the **Agra–Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी)** belt; Haldighati is a narrow **Aravalli** (अरावली) pass near Gogunda.
22. Cause–course–result for Khanwa: Sanga built a post-Panipat confederacy, Babur used Araba and Tulughma, and the Rajput challenge to early Mughal (मुग़ल) power broke.
23. Cause–course–result for Haldighati: Pratap refused submission, Man Singh led the imperial wing, and Pratap withdrew to continue guerrilla resistance.
24. **Tansen** (तानसेन) served Rewa/Bhata before Akbar; do not treat **Udai Singh of Mewar** as his pre-Akbar patron fact.

📋 Must-score facts — clan, battle, Chittor

Clan ↔ state

Clan	State / seat
Sisodia	**Mewar** (Chittor → Udaipur)
Rathore	**Marwar** (Jodhpur); Bikaner branch
Kachhwaha	**Amber / Jaipur**
Bhati	**Jaisalmer**
Hada	**Bundi–Kota**

Title tags

Title	House
Maharana / Rana	**Mewar**
Rao	**Marwar / Bikaner**

Battle ↔ year

Battle	Year	Lock
Khanwa	**16 March 1527**	Babur vs **Rana Sanga**
Haldighati	**18 June 1576**	Man Singh vs **Pratap** (Akbar absent)
Sammel	**1544**	Sher Shah vs Maldeo; **Jayata–Kumpa** (Marwar)
Alauddin's Chittor (अलाउद्दीन)	**1303**	Khalji sack
Akbar's (अकबर) Chittor	**1567–68**	Jaimal–Patta; jauhar
Amar Singh–Jahangir peace	**1615**	Mewar honour kept

Ruler ↔ lock

Ruler	Lock
Rana Hammir	Mewar restorer (~**1326**); not Hamir Deva of Ranthambore
Rana Kumbha	**Vijay Stambha** at Chittor
Rana Sanga	Khanwa **1527**
Maharana Pratap	Haldighati; died **1597**
Rao Jodha	Founded **Jodhpur 1459**
Man Singh	Amber; ~**7000** zat; Haldighati commander

Monument pair (Chittor)

Tower	Lock
Vijay Stambha	**Kumbha** victory tower
Kirti Stambha	Older **Jain** tower

Topic 10 — Sikhism

Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. **Guru Nanak (गुरु नानक) (1469–1539)** founded Sikhism on **Ik Onkar**, the householder path, **langar** (लंगर), and **sangat** (संगत).
2. The ethical triad is **Naam Japna**, **Kirat Karni**, and **Vand Chakna**.
3. **Mardana** (मर्दाना) was Nanak's Muslim **rabab** companion and **disciple**, not a Guru.
4. There are exactly **ten human Gurus** from Nanak to Gobind Singh (**1469–1708**); after that the Granth is eternal.
5. **Guru Angad** (earlier **Bhai Lehna (लेहना)**) standardised **Gurmukhi**; **Guru Amar Das** organised **22 Manjis** and made langar firm at **Goindwal**.
6. **Akbar** (अकबर) granted about **500 bighas** (with a pond) to **Bibi Bhani**, wife of **Guru Ram Das**; **Ramdaspur** on that land became **Amritsar** (अमृतसर).
7. **Guru Arjan** (गुरु अर्जन) compiled the **Adi Granth (आदि ग्रंथ) in 1604**, built **Harmandir (हरमंदिर) Sahib** (हरमंदिर साहिब), started the **Masand** (मसंद) tenth, founded **Tarn Taran** and **Kartarpur**, and was martyred under **Jahangir (जहाँगीर) in 1606** after aiding **Khusrau**.
8. **Guru Hargobind (हरगोबिंद)** introduced **miri (मीरी)–piri (पीरी)** and built the **Akal Takht** (अकाल तख़्त); he did **not** create the Khalsa.
9. **Guru Tegh Bahadur** (गुरु तेग बहादुर) was executed in **Delhi in 1675** under **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब).
10. **Guru Gobind Singh** (गुरु गोबिंद सिंह) founded the **Khalsa at Anandpur (आनंदपुर) on Vaisakhi 1699** with the **Panj Pyare** (पंज प्यारे).
11. In **1708** at **Nanded (Hazur Sahib)**, Gobind Singh made **Guru Granth Sahib** (गुरु ग्रंथ साहिब) the eternal Guru; there is **no 11th human Guru**.
12. **Adi Granth** (आदि ग्रंथ) names the 1604 book; **Guru Granth Sahib** names the same canon as living Guru after 1708.
13. **Dasam Granth** (दसम ग्रंथ) is a separate corpus linked to Gobind Singh and is **not** the eternal Guru.
14. **Japji Sahib** of Nanak opens the Granth; hymns of Kabir (कबीर), Namdev (नामदेव), Ravidas, and Sheikh Farid also appear.
15. Five Ks are **Kesh, Kangha, Kara, Kachha, and Kirpan**; initiated names are **Singh** and **Kaur**.
16. Sikh **Khalsa** (खालसा) is the 1699 initiated order; Mughal (मुग़ल) **Khalsa** means **crown land**.
17. **Harmandir Sahib** is the spiritual centre; **Akal Takht** is the temporal seat beside it.
18. At **Bhangani in 1688**, Gobind Singh defeated **Pahari (पहाड़ी) hill rajas** before founding the Khalsa.
19. **Zafarnama** is Gobind Singh's **Persian** (फ़ारसी) letter to Aurangzeb.
20. **Kabir did not found Sikhism**; his hymns later entered the Granth.
21. **Har Krishan** (हर कृष्ण), the child eighth Guru, is remembered for service during a **Delhi** epidemic.
22. Arjan's martyrdom led to Hargobind's militarisation; Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom led to Gobind Singh and later the Khalsa.
23. Saint chronology bridge often used in matches: **Namdev → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya (चैतन्य)**.
24. **Ranjit Singh (रणजीत सिंह)'s Adalat-i-Ala** at **Lahore** belongs to the later Sikh Empire, not the Guru period.
25. **Guru Gobind Singh** was born at **Patna** (पटना); he died at **Nanded**, where **Hazur Sahib** stands.
26. **Banda Bahadur** (बंदा बहादुर)'s earlier name was **Lachman Dev** (Lachhman Dev); Gobind Singh gave him the Sikh name.
27. **Hem Kund** (Chamoli (चमोली), Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड)) is a famous Sikh gurudwara site linked to Gobind Singh tradition.
28. Among early Adi Granth compositions is **Jayadev**; among the last human additions is **Guru Tegh Bahadur**.

📋 Must-score facts — Gurus, Granth, Khalsa

Ten Gurus (दस गुरु) (order)

#	Guru	Tag
1	Nanak	Founder; Ik Onkar; langar
2	Angad (Lehna)	**Gurmukhi**
3	Amar Das	**22 Manjis**; Goindwal langar
4	Ram Das	Amritsar / Ramdaspur (Akbar grant to Bibi Bhani)
5	Arjan	**Adi Granth 1604**; Harmandir; martyred **1606** (Jahangir)
6	Hargobind	**Miri–Piri**; Akal Takht

#	Guru	Tag
7	Har Rai (राई)	Continuity
8	Har Krishan	Child Guru; Delhi epidemic service
9	Tegh Bahadur	Martyred **Delhi 1675** (Aurangzeb)
10	Gobind Singh	**Khalsa 1699**; eternal Granth **1708** Nanded

Book / institution ↔ lock

Item	Lock
Adi Granth	Compiled **1604** by Arjan
Guru Granth Sahib	Eternal Guru after **1708**
Dasam Granth	Separate Gobind Singh corpus (not eternal Guru)
Harmandir Sahib	Spiritual centre
Akal Takht	Temporal seat (Hargobind)
Khalsa	**Anandpur, Vaisakhi 1699**; Panj Pyare
Five Ks	Kesh, Kangha, Kara, Kachha, Kirpan
Zafarnama	Gobind Singh's **Persian** letter to Aurangzeb
Bhangani	**1688** vs Pahari rajas

Martyrdom pair

Guru	Year	Emperor
Arjan	**1606**	Jahangir
Tegh Bahadur	**1675**	Aurangzeb

Place tags

Place	Lock
Patna	Gobind Singh **birth**
Nanded / Hazur Sahib	Gobind Singh **death**; eternal Granth
Amritsar	Ram Das tank / Harmandir
Anandpur	Khalsa founding
Hem Kund (Chamoli, UK)	Gobind Singh tradition gurudwara

Topic 11 — Marathas

Consolidated — 29 Must-Score Facts

1. **Shivaji (1630–1680)** built swaraj (स्वराज), was crowned **Chhatrapati at Raigad (रायगढ़) in 1674** (**Gaga Bhatt / Vishweshwar** of Banaras declared him Kshatriya), and died at Raigad in **1680**.
2. He was born at **Shivneri** to **Shahji Bhonsle** and **Jijabai**; tradition remembers **Samarth Ramdas** as his guru (गुरु).
3. At **Pratapgad in 1659**, Shivaji killed Bijapur (बीजापुर)'s **Afzal Khan** and expanded western Deccan (दक्कन) power.
4. By the **Treaty of Purandar (पुरंदर) (1665)** with **Raja (राजा) Jai Singh I**, Shivaji surrendered **23 forts**; the **Agra** (आगरा) detention followed in **1666**. He defeated the Mughals at **Salher in 1672**.
5. Big **Deshmukhs** opposed an independent Maratha state because they preferred remaining **Bijapur feudal lords**.
6. The **Ashtapradhan** (अष्टप्रधान) was Shivaji's eight-minister council; under him the **Peshwa** (पेशवा) was one minister, not the sovereign.
7. Ashtapradhan portfolios: **Peshwa** (पेशवा / मुख्य प्रधान - admin), **Amatya** (अमात्य / मजूमदार - finance/revenue), **Mantri** (मंत्री / वाक़ियानवीस - records/home), **Senapati** (सेनापति / सर-ए-नौबत - army (सेना) chief), **Sumant** (सुमंत / डबीर - foreign affairs), **Nyayadish** (न्यायाधीश - justice), **Pandit Rao** (पंडितराव / दानाध्यक्ष - religious endowments), **Sachiv** (सचिव / सुरनवीस - royal correspondence).
8. **Chauth** (चौथ) is a **25%** (1/4) protection levy; **sardeshmukhi** (सरदेशमुखी) is an extra **10%** (1/10) hereditary chief claim (together up to **35%**). **Saranzami** (सरंजामी) land supported Maratha jagirdars' livelihood.
9. From **1713**, **Balaji Vishwanath** (बालाजी विश्वनाथ) made the Peshwa office **hereditary** and de facto ruling under Shahu (शाहू).
10. Core Peshwa order: **Balaji Vishwanath → Bajirao (बाजीराव) I (बाजीराव I) → Balaji Bajirao (बालाजी बाजीराव) → Madhav Rao I (माधवराव) → Narayan Rao (नारायणराव) → Raghunath Rao**.
11. **Bajirao I (1720–40)** drove north expansion; **Balaji Bajirao (1740–61)** belongs to the Panipat III generation. By the **Sangola (सांगोला) agreement (1750)**, the Chhatrapati became a do-nothing king and the **Peshwa** the real head.
12. **Madhav Rao I (1761–72)** comes **before Narayan Rao (1772–73)**; do not reverse them.
13. At **Panipat III on 14 January 1761**, **Ahmad Shah Abdali (अब्दाली)** defeated the Marathas under **Sadashiv Rao Bhau (भाऊ)**; heir **Vishwas Rao** was killed. Eyewitness **Kashiraj Pandit** called it catastrophic; immediate spark was Maratha expulsion of Abdali's viceroy (वायसराय) **Timur Shah** from **Lahore**.
14. Panipat III is not Panipat I (**1526**) or II (**1556**); **Shivaji** (शिवाजी) was already dead and did not fight it.
15. **Nadir Shah (नादिर शाह)'s Delhi sack (1739)** is a separate Afghan shock from Abdali's Panipat victory.
16. After Shivaji, **Sambhaji** (सम्भाजी) was executed in **1689**; **Rajaram** then **Tarabai** (for **Shivaji II**) led resistance; at **Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s death** Maratha leadership was with **Tarabai**. **Shahu** was released after **1707** and the Peshwa line rose.
17. Later confederacy seats: **Peshwa–Pune (पुणे)**, **Scindia–Gwalior**, **Holkar–Indore**, **Gaekwad–Baroda**, **Bhonsle–Nagpur**.
18. The **Treaty of Lanavada (लानावड़ा) (1718)** won Mughal (मुग़ल) recognition (मान्यता) of Maratha chauth rights.
19. **Palkhed (1728)** is Bajirao I's famous campaign against the **Nizam** (निजाम).
20. Shivaji's navy used Konkan forts such as **Sindhudurg** and **Vijaydurg**.
21. Maratha **chauth** reached the **Doab** (दोआब), **Bundelkhand**, and **Rohilkhand**.
22. Peshwa power ended with the British in **1818**; the last Peshwa was **Baji Rao II**.
23. **Shaista Khan** was raided in Pune in **1663** before the Purandar settlement.
24. **Abwab** (अबवाब) and **Jamadani** are distractors; the protection revenue name asked is **Chauth**.
25. Cause–course–result for Purandar: Aurangzeb sent Jai Singh, Shivaji surrendered forts under treaty, then recovered strength toward the 1674 coronation.
26. Cause–course–result for Panipat III: Maratha northern surge met Abdali and Najib-ud-Daula; Bhau's army was crushed; the all-India northern surge broke though the confederacy survived.
27. **Modi script** (मोड़ी लिपि) was used in Maratha revenue and administrative papers.
28. **Ahilyabai Holkar** (अहल्याबाई होल्कर) ruled from the **Holkar** house of **Indore**.
29. Ashtapradhan ministers headed departments but did **not** hold independent cabinet power; Shivaji could accept or reject advice.

📋 Must-score facts — Ashtapradhan, Peshwa, battles

Ashtapradhan portfolio

Minister	Charge
Peshwa	Administration
Amatya	Finance
Mantri	Records
Senapati	Army
Sumant	Foreign affairs
Nyayadish	Justice
Pandit Rao	Religion
Sachiv	Correspondence

Revenue tags

Term	Lock
Chauth (चौथ)	**25%** protection levy
Sardeshmukhi (सरदेशमुखी)	Extra **10%** hereditary chief claim
Saranzami (सरंजामी)	Jagirdar livelihood land
Modi script (मोड़ी लिपि)	Maratha admin / revenue papers

Peshwa order

Balaji Vishwanath → Bajirao I → Balaji Bajirao → Madhav Rao I → Narayan Rao → Raghunath Rao → ... → Baji Rao II (last)

Battle / treaty ↔ year

Event	Year	Lock
Pratapgad (Afzal Khan)	**1659**	Shivaji
Shaista Khan raid (Pune)	**1663**	Shivaji
Treaty of Purandar	**1665**	23 forts to Jai Singh
Salher	**1672**	vs Mughals
Coronation (Raigad)	**1674**	Chhatrapati
Shivaji death	**1680**	Raigad
Sambhaji executed	**1689**	—
Lanavada	**1718**	Chauth recognition
Palkhed	**1728**	Bajirao vs Nizam
Sangola	**1750**	Peshwa real head
Panipat III	**14 Jan 1761**	Abdali vs Bhau
Maratha power ends	**1818**	Baji Rao II

Confederacy seats

House	Seat
Peshwa	**Pune**
Scindia	**Gwalior**
Holkar	**Indore**
Gaekwad	**Baroda**
Bhonsle	**Nagpur**

Topic 12 — Later Medieval India

Consolidated — 39 Must-Score Facts

1. Sea-power arrival order: **Portuguese 1498 → Dutch ~1605 → English Surat factory (फैक्टरी) 1613 (सूरत) → Danish Tranquebar (ट्रैंकेबार) 1620 → French Pondicherry (पांडिचेरी) 1674**.
2. Charter fact: **EIC 1600** (ईआईसी), **VOC 1602** (वीओसी), **Danish 1616**, **French 1664** — the English charter comes **before** the Dutch.
3. **Vasco da Gama (गामा)** reached **Calicut in 1498**; **Afonso de Albuquerque (अल्बुकर्क)** captured **Goa (गोवा) in 1510** and made it Portuguese India's capital.
4. Portuguese **cartaze** (कार्टाज़) was an ocean pass-fee; **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ) expelled the Portuguese from **Hooghly (हुगली) in 1632**.
5. The Dutch **VOC** used **Pulicat** as its South Indian headquarters and **Chinsurah** (चिन्सुरा) as its Bengal factory.
6. **William Hawkins (हॉकिन्स)** reached India in **1608** on the *Hector*, spoke **Turkish**, and met Jahangir (जहाँगीर); the trap year **1611** is false for arrival.
7. **Sir Thomas Roe (रो)** was ambassador at Jahangir's court from **1615 to 1619**.
8. English factory spine: temporary **Masulipatnam 1611** (मसूलिपत्तनम), permanent **Surat 1613** (सूरत), **Madras/Fort St George 1640**, Bombay leased **1668** (Portuguese dowry to Charles II, **1662**), **Calcutta** via **Job Charnock** at **Sutanuti**. **Levant (लेवेंट) Company (1592)** got a land-route charter before the sea EIC (**1600**, under **Akbar** (अकबर)).
9. **Colbert** founded the French company (**1664**) under **Louis XIV**; earliest French factory **Surat 1668** (**François Caron**); HQ **Pondicherry (1674)**; Bengal factory **Chandernagore** (चंद्रनगर). **Dupleix** (डुप्ले) first used European troops in Indian succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) quarrels.
10. **First Carnatic (कर्नाटक) War (1746–48)**: immediate spark = English capture of French ships (नावाध्यक्ष) (**Captain Bernett**); French won **St. Thome** (सेंट थॉम) on the Adyar vs Anwaruddin's force; **Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)** (एक्स-ला-शापेल) returned **Madras**. **Second Carnatic** opens with **Ambur (1749)**; **Wandiwash (वांडिवाश) (1760)** = British (**Eyre Coote**) defeat French (**Count de Lally**); **Paris 1763** ends the Third.
11. Danish facts are **Tranquebar (1620)** and **Serampore** (श्रीरामपुर) in Bengal; Denmark sold its Indian settlements in **1845**.
12. Traveller chronology: **Ralph Fitch (फिच) 1585 → Hawkins 1608 (हॉकिन्स) → Nicholas Downton 1614 → Roe 1615**.
13. **Bernier** (बर्नियर) was a **French** traveller at Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s court, not an English EIC envoy.
14. **Saadat Khan (सादात खान) Burhan-ul-Mulk** founded the **Awadh** (अवध) Nawabi in **1722**; he is not Bengal's Murshid (पीर) Quli (मुर्शिद क़ुली) Khan (मुर्शिद कुली खान).
15. **Shuja-ud-Daula** (शुजाउद्दौला) stood with Abdali (अब्दाली) at **Panipat (पानीपत) III (1761)**; after Buxar (बक्सर) came the **Treaty of Allahabad (इलाहाबाद की संधि) (1765)**.
16. **Asaf-ud-Daula** (आसफउद्दौला) made **Lucknow** (लखनऊ) the capital and built the **Bara Imambara**.
17. The British annexed **Awadh in 1856**; **Wajid Ali Shah** (वाजिद अली शाह) was the last Nawab.
18. Later chronology bridge: **Awadh annexation 1856 → Indigo (नील) Revolt 1859 → Second Afghan War 1878 → Ilbert Bill 1883 (इल्बर्ट)**.
19. An early European **factory** was a trading post with godowns and guards, not yet a full colony (उपनिवेश); trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) needed Mughal **farmans**.
20. Under **Dupleix**, the French took **Madras in 1746** during the First Carnatic War before Aix-la-Chapelle restored it.
21. Do not confuse **Aix-la-Chapelle 1748** with the later **Treaty of Paris 1763** ending the Seven Years' War.
22. **Ralph Fitch** saw **Agra** (आगरा) and **Banaras** in Akbar's time, before any lasting EIC factory.
23. **Begum Hazrat Mahal** (बेगम हज़रत महल) led Lucknow resistance after 1856 annexation fed the **1857** rising.
24. **Safdar Jung** also served as Mughal **Wazir** (वज़ीर); **Serampore** is Danish, not French.
25. Cause–course–result for Portuguese arrival: they sought a sea spice route, Gama reached Calicut, and Albuquerque's Goa made them a coastal maritime power.
26. Cause–course–result for Awadh's end: Nawabi autonomy from 1722 weakened after Buxar, Dalhousie (डलहौज़ी) annexed the state in 1856, and Lucknow became a major **1857** centre.
27. After **Aurangzeb (1707)**, **Bahadur Shah I (बहादुर शाह I) (Muazzam / Shah Alam)** ruled **1707–1712**; Khafi Khan called him **Shahe Bekhabar**.
28. **Jahandar Shah** rose with **Zulfiqar Khan** (ज़ुल्फ़िक़ार) and was defeated and killed by nephew **Farrukh Siyar** (फ़र्रुख़) in **1713**.
29. **Farrukh Siyar's 1717 farman (फ़रमान)** gave the English **duty-free trade in Bengal** for an annual lump sum of about **Rs 3,000**.

30. **Sayyid (सैयद) brothers** (सैय्यद) (**Abdullah** and **Hussain Ali**) were the later-Mughal **king-makers** (**1713–1720**).
31. **Muhammad Shah Rangeela (रंगीला) (1719–1748)** was the last emperor to sit on the **Peacock Throne**; **Nadir Shah** (नादिर शाह) defeated him at **Karnal (1739)** and took the throne and **Kohinoor**.
32. **Chin Qilich Khan (Nizam-ul-Mulk (निजाम-उल-मुल्क) Asaf Jah)** founded independent **Hyderabad** after defeating **Mubariz Khan** at **Shakar Kheda (खेड़ा) (1724)**.
33. **Sawai Jai Singh II** built **Jantar Mantar** observatories at **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain (उज्जैन), Mathura (मथुरा), and Varanasi (वाराणसी)** (not Allahabad) and prepared **Zij Muhammad Shahi**.
34. Last Mughal **Bahadur Shah Zafar** (बहादुर शाह ज़फ़र) (son of **Akbar II**) was an emperor without an empire; teachers include **Zauq** and **Ghalib**; spiritual guide **Hasan Askari**.
35. Arrival order of European traders: **Portuguese** → **Dutch** → **English** → **Danes** → **French**. Portuguese were **first to arrive (1498)** and **last to leave (1961)**.
36. First Portuguese fort in India: **Cochin 1503** (Albuquerque, before he was Viceroy (वायसराय)). First Portuguese factory: **Calicut 1500**. **Nuno da Cunha** shifted HQ **Cochin** → **Goa**.
37. Portuguese used **Hooghly** as a Bay of Bengal piracy base; **Shah Jahan** crushed them there in **1632**. Dutch Bengal hub **Chinsurah** had **Fort Gustavus (गुस्तावस) (1653)**; Dutch took Kochi and built **Fort Williams (1663)**.
38. **Thomas Best** broke Portuguese naval monopoly at **Swally** near Surat. **Sir John Child** was expelled by **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) after attacking Mughal ports (**1688**).
39. First modern **Municipal Corporation** in India: **Madras, 1688**. Europeans prized **Bihar** for high-grade **opium** and **saltpetre**.

📋 Must-score facts — Europeans, Awadh, Later Mughals

European arrival order

Portuguese 1498 → Dutch ~1605 → English Surat 1613 → Danish Tranquebar 1620 → French Pondicherry 1674

Company	Charter year
EIC	**1600**
VOC	**1602**
Danish	**1616**
French	**1664**

Person ↔ tag

Person	Lock
Vasco da Gama	Calicut **1498**
Albuquerque	Goa **1510**; real founder
Almeida (अल्मेदा)	First Viceroy (कैनिंग); Blue Water (ब्लू वॉटर)
William Hawkins	*Hector* **1608**; Turkish; Jahangir
Sir Thomas Roe	Ambassador **1615–19**
Job Charnock	Calcutta / Sutanuti
Dupleix	French troops in succession wars
Colbert	French company **1664**

English factory spine

Place	Year
Masulipatnam (temporary)	**1611**
Surat (permanent)	**1613**
Madras / Fort St George	**1640**
Bombay lease	**1668**
Calcutta	Charnock / Sutanuti

Carnatic / treaty tags

Event	Year	Lock
First Carnatic War	**1746–48**	Aix-la-Chapelle returns Madras
Ambur	**1749**	Second Carnatic opens
Wandiwash	**1760**	Eyre Coote vs Lally
Treaty of Paris	**1763**	Ends Third / Seven Years' War

Awadh / Later Mughal tags

Item	Lock
Saadat Khan	Awadh Nawabi **1722**
Asaf-ud-Daula	Lucknow capital; **Bara Imambara**
Wajid Ali Shah	Last Nawab; annexation **1856**
Farrukh Siyar farman	**1717** duty-free Bengal trade
Sayyid brothers	King-makers **1713–1720**
Nadir Shah	**Karnal 1739**; Peacock Throne / Kohinoor
Nizam-ul-Mulk	Hyderabad after **Shakar Kheda 1724**
Sawai Jai Singh II	Jantar Mantar (Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Mathura, Varanasi)

Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Kattyuri Dynasty

Consolidated — 22 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Katyuri / Kattyuri** house (c. **740–1050 CE**) is the first historic (ऐतिहासिक) empire of Uttarakhand spanning Garhwal and Kumaon.
2. First capital was **Joshimath (Kartikeyapura)** in the Alaknanda (अलकनंदा) valley; later capital was **Baijnath** in the fertile **Katyur valley** (Bageshwar (बागेश्वर)) on the Gomti.
3. Capital shift Cause–Course–Result: severe winters, landslides, and northern raids → move from Joshimath to Baijnath (~9th/10th c.) → safer agrarian base in Katyur valley.
4. Founder tradition names **Basantandev (Basu Dev)** with the title **Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja (महाराजाधिराज)**.
5. Three ruling houses run **Basantandev → Nimbar → Salonaditya**.
6. **Ishtaganadeva** (son of Nimbar and Queen Nasu Devi) was the first ruler to **unify Garhwal and Kumaon** under one central rule.
7. Ishtaganadeva built rock temples at Joshimath including **Navadurga**, **Lakulisa**, and **Mahishamardini** shrines.
8. **Lalitsuradeva** is the apex builder-king (reign over **44** years); Pandukeshwar plates praise him like **Varaha** and **Bhagiratha** for roads, bridges (*Setu*), and pilgrim rest houses.
9. Two copper plates of Lalitsuradeva at **Pandukeshwar** (near Joshimath) date to his **21st** and **22nd** regnal years.
10. **Bageshwar Stone Inscription** of **Bhuwandev** gives Nimbar-house genealogy and records grants to **Vyaghreswar** (Bageshwar) Shiva temple.
11. **Padmata** and **Subhiksharaja** also leave Pandukeshwar-plate memory in the later Salonaditya phase.
12. Admin titles: **Mahasamanta** = feudatory/military chief; **Kottapala** = fort and pass commander; **Doshaparadhika** = crime investigator; **Dandapashika / Dandanayaka** = chief magistrate.
13. Revenue and transit: **Bhogika / Mahabhogika** collected agricultural *Bhoga*; **Saulkika** took tolls and customs; **Tarika / Ghattapala** supervised ferries and bridges.
14. Court and household: **Pratihara / Mahapratihara (महाप्रतिहार)** regulated audiences; **Khadgika** was the sword bodyguard; **Kishorvadhabhikrit** ran horse studs.
15. The dynasty fell under tyrant **Bir Dev (Biram Dev)** through extortion, forced labour, and a popular peasant rebellion that shattered unified rule.
16. After Bir Dev, power fragmented into **Askot (Rajbar)**, **Doti (Raiyka)**, **Dwarahat**, and **Baijnath** branches.
17. **Askot** branch was founded by **Abhay Pal** (grandson of Bir Dev) in **1279** in the Askot–Didihat belt of Pithoragarh (पिथौरागढ़).
18. **Dwarahat** branch built the dense stone temple clusters called the "**Khajuraho (खजुराहो) of Kumaon**."
19. Baijnath remnant was later annexed by the **Chand** dynasty under Bharati Chand and Balo Kalyan Chand.
20. **Kartikeyapura** is Katyuri capital memory; **Brahmapura** is the earlier 6th–7th century kingdom named by Hiuen Tsang — do not merge them.
21. **Ishtaganadeva** = great unifier; **Lalitsuradeva** = greatest builder/Pandukeshwar reign — keep the pair separate.
22. Successor states after Katyuri break-up: **Chand** at Champawat (चंपावत) (Kumaon) and **Parmar** at Chandpur Garhi (Garhwal).

Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Parmar Dynasty of Garhwal

Consolidated — 22 Must-Score Facts

1. **Parmar / Panwar** of Garhwal claimed Malwa Parmar origin; legendary founder **Kanakpal** (888 CE tradition) sat at **Chandpur / Chandpurgarh** (Chamoli (चमोली)).
2. **Ajay Pal** (37th ruler, c. **1500–1519**) unified the **52 Garhs**, followed Gorakhnath/Rajrajeshwari devotion, and set grain measure **Dhulia Patha** (~2 seers).
3. Capital chronology: **Chandpurgarh → Dewalgarh (1512) → Srinagar (1517)** under Ajay Pal.
4. **Balbhadra Shah** (43rd) was the first to fix the royal surname **Shah** (replacing Pal), linked to Delhi Sultan contacts.
5. **Mahipat Shah** (**Garh-Bhanjan**) invaded western Tibet; legendary commanders were **Madho Singh Bhandari**, **Lodi Rikhola**, and **Banwari Das**.
6. **Madho Singh Bhandari** cut the **Maletha Canal (Kuhl)** through a mountain; tradition says he sacrificed his son **Gajendra**.
7. **Rani Karnavati** (regent **1631–40** for Prithvipati Shah) defeated Shah Jahan (शाहजहाँ)'s general **Najabat Khan** in the Doon (**1635**) and cut noses of survivors — hence **Nakkati Rani**.
8. **1635 Nakkati Rani** Cause–Course–Result: Mughal (मुग़ल) push into Doon → Karnavati's victory over Najabat Khan → surviving captives mutilated and Mughal prestige hit in Garhwal.
9. In **May 1658**, **Prithvipati Shah** sheltered **Sulaiman Shikoh** (eldest son of Dara (दारा) Shikoh (दारा शिकोह)); painters **Shyamdas** and **Hardas** became court **Tasbirdars** (तस्बीरदार).
10. **Medini Shah** later betrayed Sulaiman to Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s side and was disowned by Prithvipati.
11. Garhwal miniature line: **Shyamdas → Hardas → Hiralal → Mangatram → Mola Ram (1743–1833)**.
12. **Mola Ram** was poet–painter–historian of *Garh-Rajvansh Kavya (काव्य)*; modern fame came through **Barrister Mukandi Lal**'s *Garhwal Painting* (**1968**).
13. **Fateh Shah** (**1684–1716**) kept court **Navratnas** (Matiram, Jatadhar, Ratan Kavi) in Garhwal's cultural peak under Aurangzeb's age.
14. Fateh Shah invited **Guru (गुरु) Ram Rai (राई)** (**1676**) and granted four Dehradun villages: **Khurbura, Rajpur, Chamasari, Dhamawala**.
15. **Battle of Bhangani (1688)** Cause–Course–Result: hill politics near Paonta → Fateh Shah fought **Guru Gobind Singh (गुरु गोबिंद सिंह)** → recorded in *Bichitra Natak*; keep it distinct from Khudbuda **1804**.
16. **Pradyumna Shah** briefly ruled Kumaon as **Pradyumna Chand**, then reclaimed Garhwal; he died at **Battle of Khudbuda (Dehradun (देहरादून))** on **14 May 1804** against Gorkhas under **Amar Singh Thapa**.
17. Admin ladder: King → **Mukhtiyar / Wazir / Chautariya** → **Diwan** → **Daftari / Bakshi** → **Negi / Thokdar / Kameen / Sayana** → village **Pradhan**.
18. Land types: **Talaon** = irrigated valley (highest revenue); **Upraon** = rain-fed terrace; **Ijran / Katil** = steep bush land under periodic tillage.
19. **Sahajpal**'s **1561** bell inscription at Raghunath Temple, Devprayag (देवप्रयाग), marks Akbar (अकबर)-age Garhwal memory.
20. **Shyam Shah** visited Jahangir (जहाँगीर) at Agra (**1621**) and appears in *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri* (तुजुक-ए-जहाँगीरी).
21. **Kanakpal** = legendary founder at Chandpurgarh; **Ajay Pal** = 52-Garh unifier and Srinagar capital — never swap.
22. **Battle of Bhangani (1688)** ≠ **Battle of Khudbuda (1804)** — Sikh hill clash vs final Gorkha conquest of independent Garhwal.

Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Chand Dynasty of Kumaon

Consolidated — 24 Must-Score Facts

1. **Chand** dynasty of Kumaon used the **Garud** emblem; founder **Somchand** (c. 10th/11th c. Jhusi/Prayag (प्रयाग) legend) built **Rajbunga Fort** at **Champawat (चंपावत)**.
2. **Char Aal** guard clans appointed by Somchand: **Karki, Bora (बोरा), Taragi (Tadagi), Chaudhary** at the four gates of Rajbunga.
3. Capital movement: **Champawat** → shift begun by **Bhishm Chand** (Khagmara) → completed by **Balo Kalyan Chand** to **Almora in 1563** (Alamnagar/Rajapur).
4. **Garud Gyan Chand** (**1374–1419**) was the first Chand to visit the Delhi court; **Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक)** gave the title **Garud** and Terai (तराई)–Bhabhar gains followed.
5. **Bharti Chand** (**1437–1477**) fought a **12-year war** against Doti (Nepal) Raiyka kings to end tributary status; prolonged camps are linked to **Nayak caste** origin memory.
6. **Rudra Chand** (**1568–1597**) met **Akbar (अकबर) at Lahore (1588)**, gained the **84-Mal** Terai farman (फ़रमान), built **Malla Mahal (महाल)**, and wrote *Syenika Shastra* and *Traivarnika Dharma Nirnaya*.
7. Rudra Chand's social code ranked Brahmins as **Chauthani** (Joshi, Pant, Pandey, Tiwari) above **Pitiya/Panchbidiya**, and used **Oliya** Brahmins for weather omens.
8. **Laxmi Chand** attacked Parmar Garhwal seven times and failed (*Lakhuli Bidal* joke); he set dual courts **Vali** (high civil) and **Dungi** (military/common).
9. **Baz Bahadur Chand** (**1638–1678**) allied with Shah Jahan (शाहजहाँ)/Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब), took **Taklakot (Purang)** in western Tibet, and secured Kailash–Mansarovar routes.
10. Baz Bahadur levied **Ghyoo-kar** (ghee tax) on Tibet trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) to fund pilgrim dharmashalas and brought the **Nanda Devi** (नंदा देवी) idol from Badhangarh to Kot Almora.
11. **Jagat Chand** (**1708–1720**) marks Kumaon's "Golden Age"; he took Garhwal's Srinagar and assigned its revenues to **Badrinath (बद्रीनाथ)**.
12. **Devi Chand** (**1720–1726**) is remembered as the "**Tughlaq of Kumaon**" for whimsical grants and failed Delhi ambitions.
13. **Kalyan Chand IV** faced **Rohilla** invasion under **Ali Muhammad Khan** (**1743–44**); Almora was sacked until Garhwal's **Pradeep Shah** paid about **3 lakh** to buy withdrawal.
14. Kingmaker **Harsh Dev Joshi** invited rival Garhwal and later Gorkha interventions into Kumaon faction fights.
15. **Battle of Hawalbagh (Jan 1790)** Cause–Course–Result: Gorkha dual advance under **Amar Singh Thapa**, **Joga Malla**, and **Hastidal Chautariya** → routed **Mahendra Chand** and Lal Singh → ended 800+ years of Chand rule.
16. Chand admin units ran **Mandal** → **Pargana (परगना)** → **Patti** → **Gaon**; officers included **Diwan/Wazir (वज़ीर)**, **Bhandari**, **Kotwal/Prahari**, and hereditary **Thokdar / Kameen / Sayana**.
17. Famous tax matrix **36 Rakam 32 Kalam** = 36 principal taxes + 32 clerical/court fees.
18. High-yield Rakam samples: **Sirtee** (land cash), **Jhoolia** (bridge crossing), **Mangya** (war levy), **Bhent** (tribute gifts), **Ghyoo-kar** (ghee), **Tand-kar** (loom), **Ghodiyalo** (cavalry fodder).
19. **Kameen-chari / Sayana-chari** funded hereditary collectors; **Khor-Dungar** was pasture/forest grass cess.
20. Somchand also set rural heads **Burha** and **Sayana** with panchayats under Champawat rule.
21. Chand architectural memory includes Almora forts/palaces (**Malla Mahal**) and Champawat's Rajbunga as the founding fort.
22. Do not confuse **Garud Gyan Chand** (Firoz-era title) with **Rudra Chand** (Akbar-era 84-Mal farman).
23. Do not confuse **Hawalbagh 1790** (Kumaon Chand end) with Garhwal's **Khudbuda 1804** (Parmar end).
24. Emblem **Garud** and title origin under Gyan Chand remain the standard Chand identity pair for match stems.